GRADE 11 · ALGEBRA AND CALCULUS · QUARTER I

The derivative and its applications

A workbook to be written in. Each topic runs Focus (easy), Practice (medium), Challenge (hard) and Beyond (very hard, olympiad). Answers, with solutions for the Beyond questions, are at the back.

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11 topics · 495 questions · 45 per topic

Increments, and the problem of the tangent

The step across, the step up, and the ratio between them — the one quotient the whole of this term is built on.

Lessons 1–2 · Algebra and Calculus 11, §1.1 · Pure Mathematics 1, 7.1 · 45 questions

KEY WORDS

- increment of the argument
- increment of the function
- difference quotient
- average rate of change
- secant
- tangent
- gradient
- limiting position
- instantaneous rate

REMEMBER

1. Increment of the argument $\Delta x = x_2 - x_1$; increment of the function $\Delta y = f(x_1 + \Delta x) - f(x_1)$.
2. The quotient $\dfrac{\Delta y}{\Delta x}$ is the gradient of the secant through the two points.
3. Average rate of change on $[a, b]$ is $\dfrac{f(b) - f(a)}{b - a}$.
4. The tangent is the limiting position of the secant as $\Delta x \to 0$.
5. Simplify $\dfrac{\Delta y}{\Delta x}$ completely before letting $\Delta x \to 0$ — the h in the denominator must cancel.

Focus

EASY · 10 questions

The basic skill, one step at a time.

1. $f(x) = 3x + 1$. Find Δy as x goes from 2 to 5.

2. $f(x) = x^2$. Find Δy as x goes from 1 to 4.

3. $f(x) = x^2$. Find $\dfrac{\Delta y}{\Delta x}$ on $[1, 4]$.

4. $f(x) = 2x - 7$. Find Δy when $\Delta x = 0.5$.

5. $f(x) = x^2$. Find Δy at $x = 3$ with $\Delta x = h$.

6 $f(x) = x^2$. Simplify $\frac{\Delta y}{\Delta x}$ at $x = 3$.

7 $f(x) = 5$. Find Δy for any Δx.

8 Find the gradient of the secant to $y = x^2$ through $(1, 1)$ and $(3, 9)$.

9 Find the average rate of change of $f(x) = x^3$ on $[0, 2]$.

10 A car covers 120 km in 2 hours. Find its average speed.

Practice

MEDIUM 10 questions

The same skill with more to simplify first.

1 $f(x) = x^2 + 2x$. Find Δy at $x = 1$ with $\Delta x = h$.

2 For $f(x) = x^2 + 2x$ simplify $\frac{\Delta y}{\Delta x}$ at $x = 1$.

3 $f(x) = \frac{1}{x}$. Find Δy at $x = 2$ with $\Delta x = h$.

4 For $f(x) = \frac{1}{x}$ simplify $\frac{\Delta y}{\Delta x}$ at $x = 2$.

5 $f(x) = x^3$. Find Δy at $x = 1$ with $\Delta x = h$.

6 For $f(x) = x^3$ simplify $\frac{\Delta y}{\Delta x}$ at $x = 1$.

7 Find the gradient of the secant to $y = \frac{1}{x}$ through $x = 1$ and $x = 2$.

8 Find the average rate of change of $f(x) = x^2 - 3x$ on $[2, 5]$.

9 $s(t) = t^2 + t$. Find the average speed on $[1, 3]$.

10 $f(x) = \sqrt{x}$. Find Δy at $x = 4$ with $\Delta x = h$.

Challenge

HARD 10 questions

Letters in place of numbers, and more than one idea at once.

1 $f(x) = x^2$. Show that the secant through $x = a$ and $x = a + h$ has gradient $2a + h$.

2 $f(x) = \frac{1}{x^2}$. Simplify $\frac{\Delta y}{\Delta x}$ at $x = 1$.

3 $f(x) = \sqrt{x}$. Simplify $\frac{\Delta y}{\Delta x}$ at $x = a$.

4 $f(x) = ax^2 + bx + c$. Simplify $\frac{\Delta y}{\Delta x}$ at x.

5 $f(x) = x^2$. Find h so that the secant through $x = 2$ and $x = 2 + h$ has gradient 5.

6 $f(x) = \frac{1}{x}$. Find the gradient of the secant through $x = a$ and $x = b$.

7 A stone falls $s = 5t^2$. Find its average speed on $[1, 1 + h]$.

8 State the value $10 + 5h$ approaches as $h \to 0$, and what it measures.

9 $f(x) = x^3$. Simplify $\frac{\Delta y}{\Delta x}$ at $x = a$.

10 $f(x) = \frac{x}{x + 1}$. Find Δy at $x = 0$ with $\Delta x = h$.

Beyond VERY HARD 15 questions

Olympiad work. Expect to spend real time on these — some need an idea, not just a method.

1. $f(x) = x^n$, n a positive integer. Show that the secant gradient through $x = a$ and $x = a + h$ tends to na^{n-1} as $h \to 0$.

2. $f(x) = x^2$. Find the point of $[1, 3]$ at which the tangent gradient equals the secant gradient over $[1, 3]$.

3. Prove that for any quadratic the secant gradient over $[a, b]$ equals the tangent gradient at the midpoint.

4. $f(x) = \dfrac{1}{x}$ with $0 < a < b$. Find the point of (a, b) at which the tangent gradient equals the secant gradient.

5. $f(x) = |x|$. Find the average rate of change on $[-1, 1]$, and explain why the curve has no tangent at $x = 0$.

6 Show that the secant to $y = x^3$ over $[-a, a]$ has gradient a^2.

7 $f(x) = x^2$. The secant through $x = p$ and $x = q$ has gradient $p + q$. Use this to find the tangent gradient at $x = p$.

8 Find every a for which the secant to $y = x^2$ over $[a, a + 2]$ has gradient 0.

9 A point moves with $s = t^3 - 3t$. Find the average velocity on $[1, 1 + h]$ and its limit as $h \to 0$. What does the limit say?

10 Show that the secant to $y = \sqrt{x}$ over $[a, b]$ has gradient $\dfrac{1}{\sqrt{a} + \sqrt{b}}$.

11 Two points of $y = x^2$ have x-coordinates t and $t + 2$. Show that the secant gradient equals the tangent gradient at $x = t + 1$.

12 $f(x) = x^2 + bx$. Find b so that the secant over $[0, 4]$ has gradient 1.

13 Prove that for $f(x) = \dfrac{1}{x}$ the secant gradient is negative for every pair $a, b > 0$ with $a \neq b$.

14 The average rate of change of f over $[0, x]$ is $x + 1$ for every $x > 0$, and $f(0) = 0$. Find $f(x)$.

15 $f(x) = x^2$. Find the limit of $\dfrac{f(2 + h) - f(2 - h)}{2h}$ as $h \to 0$, and compare it with the ordinary quotient.

The limit of a function

What a function does near a point, not at it — and the four techniques that get past the form $\frac{0}{0}$.

Lessons 3–4 · Algebra and Calculus 11, §1.2 · Pure Mathematics 1, 7.2 · 45 questions

KEY WORDS

- limit
- tends to
- one-sided limit
- indeterminate form
- conjugate expression
- continuous function
- point of discontinuity
- removable discontinuity
- infinity

REMEMBER

1. $\lim_{x \to a} f(x) = L$ describes f near a. The value $f(a)$ itself is irrelevant, and need not exist.
2. The limit exists only when the two one-sided limits agree.
3. Substitute first. If it gives a number, that number is the limit.
4. The form $\frac{0}{0}$ means a common factor is hiding: factorise and cancel, or multiply by the conjugate.
5. For $x \to \infty$ in a rational function, divide every term by the highest power of x.

Focus

EASY · 10 questions

The basic skill, one step at a time.

1. Find $\lim_{x \to 2} (3x + 1)$.

2. Find $\lim_{x \to 0} (x^2 - 4)$.

3. Find $\lim_{x \to 3} \frac{x^2 - 9}{x - 3}$.

4. Find $\lim_{x \to 1} \frac{x^2 - 1}{x - 1}$.

5. Find $\lim_{x \to -2} \frac{x + 2}{x^2 - 4}$.

6 Find $\lim_{x \to 4} \sqrt{x}$.

7 Find $\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{5x}{x}$.

8 Find $\lim_{x \to \infty} \frac{1}{x}$.

9 Find $\lim_{x \to 2} \frac{x^3 - 8}{x - 2}$.

10 State the value of $\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{\sin x}{x}$, with x in radians.

Practice

MEDIUM 10 questions

The same skill with more to simplify first.

1 Find $\lim_{x \to 3} \frac{x^2 - 5x + 6}{x - 3}$.

2 Find $\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{\sqrt{x + 9} - 3}{x}$.

3 Find $\lim_{x \to \infty} \frac{3x^2 + 2x}{x^2 - 1}$.

4 Find $\lim_{x \to \infty} \frac{2x + 1}{x^2 + 3}$.

5 Find $\lim_{x\to\infty} \frac{x^3+1}{x^2+1}$.

6 Find $\lim_{x\to 0} \frac{\tan x}{x}$.

7 Find $\lim_{x\to 1} \frac{x^3-1}{x^2-1}$.

8 Find $\lim_{x\to 0} \frac{1}{x}(\frac{1}{1+x} - 1)$.

9 Find $\lim_{x\to 2} \frac{x^2-4}{x^2-3x+2}$.

10 Find $\lim_{x\to 0} \frac{\sin 3x}{x}$.

Challenge

HARD 10 questions

Letters in place of numbers, and more than one idea at once.

1 Find $\lim_{x\to 0} \frac{\sin 5x}{\sin 2x}$.

2 Find $\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{1 - \cos x}{x^2}$.

3 Find $\lim_{x \to \infty} (\sqrt{x^2 + 1} - x)$.

4 Find $\lim_{x \to 1} \frac{\sqrt{x} - 1}{x - 1}$.

5 Find $\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{\sqrt{1 + x} - \sqrt{1 - x}}{x}$.

6 Find $\lim_{x \to 2} \frac{x^3 - 3x - 2}{x^2 - 4}$.

7 State the value of $\lim_{x \to \infty} (1 + \frac{1}{x})^x$.

8 Find $\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{e^x - 1}{x}$.

9 $f(x) = \dfrac{x^2 - 4}{x - 2}$ for $x \neq 2$, and $f(2) = a$. Find a so that f is continuous at 2.

10 Find the two one-sided limits of $\dfrac{|x|}{x}$ at $x = 0$, and say whether the limit exists.

Beyond

VERY HARD · 15 questions

Olympiad work. Expect to spend real time on these — some need an idea, not just a method.

1 Find $\lim_{x \to 0} \dfrac{(1 + x)^{1/3} - 1}{x}$.

2 Find $\lim_{x \to 1} \dfrac{x^n - 1}{x - 1}$ for a positive integer n.

3 Find $\lim_{x \to 0} \dfrac{\sin ax}{\sin bx}$ for constants a and $b \neq 0$.

4 Find $\lim_{x\to\infty}(\sqrt{x^2+x}-x)$.

5 Find $\lim_{x\to 0}\dfrac{\tan x-\sin x}{x^3}$.

6 Find $\lim_{x\to 0}\dfrac{1-\cos 2x}{x\cdot\sin x}$.

7 Find $\lim_{x\to 2}\dfrac{\sqrt{x+2}-2}{x-2}$.

8 State the value of $\lim_{x\to 0}(1+x)^{1/x}$ and explain its link to $\lim_{x\to\infty}(1+\dfrac{1}{x})^{x}$.

9 Use the squeeze theorem to show that $\lim_{x\to 0} x \cdot \sin \frac{1}{x} = 0$.

10 Find $\lim_{x\to \infty} x \cdot \sin \frac{1}{x}$.

11 Find a and b so that $\lim_{x\to \infty} (\frac{x^2+1}{x+1} - ax - b) = 0$.

12 Find $\lim_{x\to 1} (\frac{1}{1-x} - \frac{3}{1-x^3})$.

13 Find $\lim_{x\to 0} \frac{\sqrt{1+x} - \sqrt{1-x}}{(1+x)^{1/3} - (1-x)^{1/3}}$.

14 Show that $\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{\sin x}{x} = 1$ fails when x is measured in degrees, and find the correct value.

15 $f(x) = \frac{x^2 - 1}{|x| - 1}$. Find the limits of f as $x \to 1$ and as $x \to -1$.

The derivative of a function

The limit of the difference quotient — differentiation from first principles, and what the answer measures.

Lessons 5–6 · Algebra and Calculus 11, §1.3 · Pure Mathematics 1, 7.1–7.2 · 45 questions

KEY WORDS

- derivative
- differentiation
- from first principles
- gradient function
- differentiable
- instantaneous velocity
- Leibniz notation
- corner point
- rate of change

REMEMBER

1. $f'(x) = \lim_{h \to 0} \dfrac{f(x + h) - f(x)}{h}$.
2. Four steps: write $f(x + h)$; form Δy and simplify; divide by h; let $h \to 0$.
3. $f'(a)$ is the gradient of the tangent at $x = a$, and the instantaneous rate of change there.
4. $f'(x)$, y' and $\dfrac{dy}{dx}$ all name the same thing.
5. Differentiable at a point ⇒ continuous there. The converse is false: $|x|$ at $x = 0$.

Focus

EASY · 10 questions

The basic skill, one step at a time.

1. $f(x) = 7$. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

2. $f(x) = 4x$. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

3. $f(x) = 3x - 2$. Find $f'(x)$.

4. $f(x) = x^2$. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

5. $f(x) = x^2$. Find $f'(5)$.

6. $f(x) = x^3$. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

7 $f(x) = x^2 + 1$. Find $f'(x)$.

8 Give the gradient of the tangent to $y = x^2$ at $(3, 9)$.

9 $s(t) = t^2$. Find the velocity at $t = 4$.

10 Write the derivative of $y = x^2$ in Leibniz notation.

Practice

MEDIUM 10 questions

The same skill with more to simplify first.

1 $f(x) = 2x^2 - 3x$. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

2 $f(x) = \frac{1}{x}$. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

3 $f(x) = \frac{1}{x}$. Find $f'(2)$.

4 $f(x) = \sqrt{x}$. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

5 $f(x) = \sqrt{x}$. Find $f'(9)$.

6 $f(x) = x^2 - 4x + 1$. Find where $f'(x) = 0$.

7 $f(x) = 5x - x^2$. Find $f'(3)$.

8 $s(t) = 3t^2 + 2t$. Find the velocity at $t = 1$.

9 $f(x) = x^3 - x$. Find $f'(2)$.

10 $f(x) = \frac{1}{x^2}$. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

Challenge

HARD 10 questions

Letters in place of numbers, and more than one idea at once.

1 $f(x) = \frac{1}{x + 1}$. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

2 $f(x) = \sqrt{x + 3}$. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

3 $f(x) = ax^2 + bx + c$. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

4 $f(x) = x^4$. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

5 Show that $f(x) = |x|$ has no derivative at $x = 0$.

6 $f(x) = x|x|$. Find $f'(0)$.

7 $f(x) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{x}}$. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

8 $s(t) = t^3 - 6t^2$. Find every instant at which the velocity is zero.

9 $f(x) = x^2$. Find the point at which the tangent gradient is 7.

10 $f(x) = x^3$. Find every point at which the tangent gradient is 12.

Beyond

VERY HARD · 15 questions

Olympiad work. Expect to spend real time on these — some need an idea, not just a method.

1 $f(x) = x^n$ for a positive integer n. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

2 $f(x) = x^{1/3}$, the cube root of x. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

3 $f(x) = \sin x$. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

4 $f(x) = \cos x$. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

5 Prove that a function differentiable at a is continuous at a.

6 $f(x) = x^2$ for $x \leq 1$ and $f(x) = 2x - 1$ for $x > 1$. Is f differentiable at $x = 1$?

7 $f(x) = x^2$ for $x \leq 1$ and $f(x) = 3x - 2$ for $x > 1$. Is f differentiable at $x = 1$?

8 $f(x) = x^2 \cdot \sin\frac{1}{x}$ for $x \neq 0$ and $f(0) = 0$. Find $f'(0)$.

9 Find a and b so that $f(x) = x^2$ for $x \leq 2$ and $f(x) = ax + b$ for $x > 2$ is differentiable at $x = 2$.

10 The tangent to $y = x^2$ at $x = a$ passes through $(0, -1)$. Find a.

11 Show that the only horizontal tangent to $y = x^3$ is at the origin.

12 $f(x) = x|x|$. Show that $f'(x) = 2|x|$ for every x, including $x = 0$.

13 A particle has $s = t^3 - 3t^2 + 2$. Find its velocity, and every instant at which it is at rest.

14 Show that $f(x) = x^{2/3}$ has no derivative at $x = 0$.

15 Show that the tangent to $y = x^2$ at $x = a$ meets the curve at no other point.

The rules of differentiation

The table of derivatives, and the four rules that differentiate anything built out of it.

Lessons 7–9 · Algebra and Calculus 11, §1.4 · Pure Mathematics 1, 7.3 · 45 questions

KEY WORDS

- power rule
- constant multiple rule
- sum rule
- product rule
- quotient rule
- fractional index
- negative index
- simplify first
- second derivative

REMEMBER

1. $(x^n)' = nx^{n-1}$, for every real n — whole, negative or fractional.
2. $(cf)' = cf'$ and $(u \pm v)' = u' \pm v'$: constants come out, sums split up.
3. Product rule: $(uv)' = u'v + uv'$.
4. Quotient rule: $\left(\frac{u}{v}\right)' = \frac{u'v - uv'}{v^2}$ — the order in the numerator matters.
5. Rewrite roots and reciprocals as powers first. There is no product or quotient rule you need if the expression simplifies.

Focus

EASY · 10 questions

The basic skill, one step at a time.

1. Differentiate $y = x^5$.

2. Differentiate $y = 3x^4$.

3. Differentiate $y = x^2 + x$.

4. Differentiate $y = 7$.

5. Differentiate $y = x^{-3}$.

6. Differentiate $y = \sqrt{x}$.

7 Differentiate $y = \frac{1}{x}$.

8 Differentiate $y = 4x^3 - 2x^2 + 5$.

9 Differentiate $y = x^2 \cdot x^3$.

10 Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$ at $x = 1$ for $y = x^3$.

Practice

MEDIUM 10 questions

The same skill with more to simplify first.

1 Differentiate $y = (x + 1)(x + 2)$.

2 Differentiate $y = x^2(x - 3)$.

3 Differentiate $y = \frac{x^2 + 1}{x}$.

4 Differentiate $y = x\sqrt{x}$.

5 Differentiate $y = \frac{3}{x^2}$.

6 Differentiate $y = (2x - 1)(x + 4)$.

7 Differentiate $y = \frac{x^3 - 1}{x^2}$.

8 Differentiate $y = 5\sqrt{x} - \frac{2}{x}$.

9 Differentiate $y = (x + 1)^2$.

10 Find the second derivative of $y = x^4$.

Challenge

HARD 10 questions

Letters in place of numbers, and more than one idea at once.

1 Differentiate $y = (x^2 + 1)(x^3 - 2)$.

2 Differentiate $y = \frac{x}{x + 1}$.

3 Differentiate $y = \frac{x - 1}{x + 1}$.

4 Differentiate $y = \frac{x^2 + 1}{x - 1}$.

5 Differentiate $y = x^3\sqrt{x}$.

6 Differentiate $y = (\sqrt{x} + 1)(\sqrt{x} - 1)$.

7 Differentiate $y = \frac{2x + 1}{\sqrt{x}}$.

8 Differentiate $y = \frac{x^2}{x^2 + 1}$.

9 Find $f''(x)$ for $f(x) = \frac{1}{x}$.

10 Find the gradient of $y = \frac{x + 2}{x - 2}$ at $x = 4$.

Beyond VERY HARD 15 questions

Olympiad work. Expect to spend real time on these — some need an idea, not just a method.

1 Prove the product rule $(uv)' = u'v + uv'$ from first principles.

2 Deduce the quotient rule from the product rule.

3 Prove that $(uvw)' = u'vw + uv'w + uvw'$.

4 Show that $\left(\frac{1}{v}\right)' = -\frac{v'}{v^2}$.

5 Differentiate $y = (x - 1)(x - 2)(x - 3)$.

6 Find every x at which $y = x^3 - 3x$ has gradient 0.

7 $f(x) = x^2 g(x)$, where $g(2) = 3$ and $g'(2) = -1$. Find $f'(2)$.

8 $f(x) = \dfrac{x^2 + a}{x + 1}$ has a stationary point at $x = 1$. Find a.

9 Show that $y = x + \dfrac{1}{x}$ has gradient zero exactly at $x = 1$ and $x = -1$.

10 Find the second derivative of $y = \dfrac{x + 1}{x - 1}$.

11 Prove that the derivative of an even function is odd.

12 Prove that the derivative of an odd function is even.

13 $f(x) = x^n$ for a positive integer n. Show that the n-th derivative is the constant $n!$.

14 Find every polynomial f with $f'(x) = f(x)$ for all x.

15 $y = x^3 + ax + b$ has a stationary point at $x = 2$ and passes through $(0, 1)$. Find a and b.

The derivative of a composite function

The chain rule — differentiate the outside, then multiply by the derivative of the inside.

Lessons 10–12 · Algebra and Calculus 11, §1.5 · Pure Mathematics 1, 7.4 · Pure Mathematics 2, 4.4 · 45 questions

KEY WORDS

- chain rule
- composite function
- inner function
- outer function
- intermediate variable
- bracket power
- substitution u
- connected rates

REMEMBER

1. $\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{dy}{du} \cdot \frac{du}{dx}$ — the intermediate variable cancels like a fraction.
2. $[f(g(x))]' = f'(g(x)) \cdot g'(x)$: outer derivative at the inner value, times the inner derivative.
3. $[(ax + b)^n]' = na(ax + b)^{n-1}$. The factor a is the mark most often lost.
4. Name the inner function before you write anything else.
5. Chains combine with the product and quotient rules: deal with the outer structure first.

Focus EASY 10 questions — The basic skill, one step at a time.

1 Differentiate $y = (x + 1)^5$.

2 Differentiate $y = (2x + 3)^4$.

3 Differentiate $y = (3x - 1)^2$.

4 Differentiate $y = (x^2 + 1)^3$.

5 Differentiate $y = \sqrt{x + 4}$.

6 Differentiate $y = (5x)^3$.

7 Differentiate $y = (1 - x)^6$.

8 Differentiate $y = (x^3 + 2)^2$.

9 Differentiate $y = \dfrac{1}{x + 1}$.

10 Differentiate $y = (4x - 7)^{10}$.

Practice

MEDIUM 10 questions

The same skill with more to simplify first.

1 Differentiate $y = \sqrt{x^2 + 1}$.

2 Differentiate $y = (x^2 - 3x)^4$.

3 Differentiate $y = \dfrac{1}{(2x + 1)^3}$.

4 Differentiate $y = (1 + \sqrt{x})^3$.

5 Differentiate $y = \sqrt{3x - 2}$.

6 Differentiate $y = (x + \dfrac{1}{x})^2$.

7 Differentiate $y = (2 - x^2)^5$.

8 Differentiate $y = \frac{1}{\sqrt{x + 1}}$.

9 Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$ at $x = 0$ for $y = \sqrt{x^2 + 1}$.

10 Differentiate $y = (\frac{x + 1}{x - 1})^2$.

Challenge

HARD 10 questions

Letters in place of numbers, and more than one idea at once.

1 Differentiate $y = x^2(2x + 1)^3$.

2 Differentiate $y = x\sqrt{x + 1}$.

3 Differentiate $y = \frac{(x + 1)^3}{x - 1}$.

4 Differentiate $y = \sqrt{x^2 + x + 1}$.

5 Differentiate $y = (1 + \sqrt{1 + x})^2$.

6 Differentiate $y = (\frac{2x - 1}{x + 2})^3$.

7 Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$ at $x = 1$ for $y = (x^2 + 3)^4$.

8 Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$ at $x = 0$ for $y = \sqrt{1 - x^2}$.

9 Differentiate $y = (3x + 1)^{1/3}$.

10 The radius of a circle grows at 2 cm/s. Find $\frac{dA}{dt}$ when $r = 5$ cm.

Beyond

VERY HARD · 15 questions

Olympiad work. Expect to spend real time on these — some need an idea, not just a method.

1. Explain why $\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{dy}{du} \cdot \frac{du}{dx}$, using increments.

2. Differentiate $y = ((x^2 + 1)^3 + 1)^2$.

3. Differentiate $y = \sqrt{x + \sqrt{x}}$.

4. $y = f(x^2)$ and $f'(1) = 3$. Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$ at $x = 1$.

5. $y = (f(x))^2$, with $f(2) = 3$ and $f'(2) = -1$. Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$ at $x = 2$.

6 A spherical balloon is inflated at 100 cm³/s. Find the rate at which the radius grows when $r = 5$ cm.

7 $y = (ax + b)^n$. Show that the n-th derivative is the constant $n!a^n$.

8 Differentiate $y = \dfrac{x}{\sqrt{1 + x^2}}$ and simplify.

9 A ladder 5 m long leans against a wall. Its foot slides out at 0.5 m/s. Find the rate at which the top slides down when the foot is 3 m from the wall.

10 $y = (1 + x)^n$. Show that $\dfrac{dy}{dx}$ at $x = 0$ is n, and say how that matches the binomial expansion.

11 $g(x) = f(2x + 1)$ and $f'(5) = 4$. Find $g'(2)$.

12 Differentiate $y = \sqrt{1 + \sqrt{1 + x}}$.

13 Show that $y = \sqrt{x^2 + 1}$ satisfies $y \cdot \dfrac{dy}{dx} = x$.

14 The edge of a cube grows at 3 cm/s. Find the rate of change of its surface area when the edge is 10 cm.

15 $y = f(g(x))$, where $f'(t) > 0$ for every t and $g'(x) < 0$ for every x. Show that y is decreasing.

Revision · Control work 1 — the derivative

Everything from lessons 1 to 12 in one place: limits, first principles, the rules, and the chain rule.

Lessons 13–14 · Control work 1 and work on the mistakes · 45 questions

KEY WORDS

- limit
- first principles
- power rule
- product rule
- quotient rule
- chain rule
- second derivative
- gradient
- rate of change

REMEMBER

1. Substitute first. The form $\frac{0}{0}$ means factorise, or use the conjugate.
2. Use first principles only when the question says so; otherwise use the rules.
3. Simplify before differentiating — it is nearly always quicker than the quotient rule.
4. The chain rule needs the inner derivative. Leaving it out is the commonest lost mark in this unit.
5. Check a derivative by substituting a value, or by differentiating a simplified form of the same function.

Focus

EASY · 10 questions

The basic skill, one step at a time.

1. Find $\lim_{x \to 1} (x^2 + 3)$.

2. Find $\lim_{x \to 2} \dfrac{x^2 - 4}{x - 2}$.

3. Differentiate $y = x^7$.

4. Differentiate $y = 5x^3 - 2x$.

5. Differentiate $y = \dfrac{1}{x^3}$.

6 Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$ at $x = 4$ for $y = \sqrt{x}$.

7 Differentiate $y = (x + 2)^4$.

8 $f(x) = 3x^2$. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

9 Differentiate $y = x(x + 1)$.

10 Find the second derivative of $y = x^3$.

Practice

MEDIUM 10 questions

The same skill with more to simplify first.

1 Find $\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{\sqrt{x + 4} - 2}{x}$.

2 Find $\lim_{x \to \infty} \frac{2x^2 + 1}{3x^2 - x}$.

3 Differentiate $y = (2x - 1)(x + 3)$.

4 Differentiate $y = \frac{x}{x^2 + 1}$.

5 Differentiate $y = \sqrt{2x + 1}$.

6 Differentiate $y = (x^2 - 1)^3$.

7 $f(x) = \frac{2}{x}$. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

8 Differentiate $y = x^2 + \frac{1}{x}$.

9 Find the gradient of $y = x^3 - x$ at $x = 2$.

10 Find where $y = x^2 - 6x$ has gradient 0.

Challenge

HARD 10 questions

Letters in place of numbers, and more than one idea at once.

1 Find $\lim_{x \to 0} \frac{\sin 4x}{3x}$.

2 Differentiate $y = x^2\sqrt{x + 1}$.

3 Differentiate $y = \frac{x - 1}{x^2 + 1}$.

4 Differentiate $y = \dfrac{1 + x}{1 - x}$.

5 $f(x) = \sqrt{2x}$. Find $f'(x)$ from first principles.

6 Find $\dfrac{dy}{dx}$ at $x = 0$ for $y = (3x^2 + 1)^5$.

7 Find a if $y = x^3 + ax$ has gradient 5 at $x = 1$.

8 Differentiate $y = \dfrac{1}{(x^2 + 1)^2}$.

9 Find the second derivative of $y = \sqrt{x}$.

10 Find $\lim_{x \to 1} \dfrac{x^3 - 1}{x - 1}$.

Beyond VERY HARD 15 questions

Olympiad work. Expect to spend real time on these — some need an idea, not just a method.

1 Find $\lim_{x\to 0} \dfrac{\sqrt{1+2x}-\sqrt{1-2x}}{x}$.

2 Differentiate $y = \dfrac{x}{1+\sqrt{x}}$ and simplify.

3 $f(x) = x^3 - 3x^2 + 2$. Find f', f'', and the point at which $f'' = 0$.

4 Show that $(x^n)' = nx^{n-1}$ still holds when n is a negative integer.

5 $f(x)g(x) = x^2$ for all x, with $f(1) = 1$, $f'(1) = 2$ and $g(1) = 1$. Find $g'(1)$.

6 Show that $\lim_{x \to 0} \dfrac{1 - \cos 3x}{x^2} = \dfrac{9}{2}$.

7 $y = (x^2 + a)^3$. Find every value of a for which the curve has exactly one point of zero gradient.

8 Find every x at which $y = x^3 - 3x^2 + 3x$ has gradient 0.

9 A particle has $s = \sqrt{t^2 + 1}$. Find its velocity at $t = 2$.

10 $z = f(2x)$. Express $\dfrac{dz}{dx}$ in terms of f', and find $\dfrac{d^2z}{dx^2}$.

11 Verify Rolle's theorem for $f(x) = x^2 - 4x + 3$ on $[1, 3]$.

12 Find $\lim_{x \to 2} \dfrac{\sqrt{x} - \sqrt{2}}{x - 2}$.

13 Show that $(fg)'' = f''g + 2f'g' + fg''$.

14 Find the cubic f with $f(0) = 1$, $f'(0) = 0$, $f''(0) = 2$ and $f'''(0) = 6$.

15 $y = (1 + x)^{100}$. Find $y'(0)$ and $y''(0)$.

UNIT 1 · CAMBRIDGE INSERT · TOPIC 7

The modulus function

Distance read off the number line — the graph of $y = |ax + b|$, and why the corner has no gradient.

Lessons 15–16 · Pure Mathematics 2, 1.1–1.2 · Cambridge insert · 45 questions

KEY WORDS

- modulus
- absolute value
- distance from zero
- vertex
- corner point
- piecewise definition
- one-sided derivative
- critical point
- case method

REMEMBER

1. $|x| = x$ for $x \geq 0$ and $-x$ for $x < 0$. Also $|x| = \sqrt{x^2}$ — never just x.
2. $|x - a|$ is the distance from x to a. This reading solves most questions faster than algebra.
3. $|f(x)| = k$ gives $f(x) = k$ or $f(x) = -k$ when $k > 0$, and nothing at all when $k < 0$.
4. $|x| < k$ means $-k < x < k$; $|x| > k$ means $x < -k$ or $x > k$ — two pieces, joined by "or".
5. $y = |f(x)|$ reflects the part below the axis upwards; $y = f(|x|)$ mirrors the right-hand part into the left.

Focus

EASY · 10 questions

The basic skill, one step at a time.

1. Evaluate $|-7|$.

2. Evaluate $|3 - 8|$.

3. Solve $|x| = 4$.

4. Solve $|x - 2| = 3$.

5. Solve $|x| = -2$.

6. Solve $|2x| = 10$.

7 Evaluate $\sqrt{(-5)^2}$.

8 Write the distance from x to 7 as a modulus.

9 Solve $|x + 1| = 0$.

10 State the vertex of $y = |x - 3|$.

Practice

MEDIUM 10 questions

The same skill with more to simplify first.

1 Solve $|2x - 1| = 7$.

2 Solve $|3x + 2| = 5$.

3 Solve $|x| < 3$.

4 Solve $|x| > 5$.

5 Solve $|x - 4| \leq 2$.

6 Solve $|x + 3| > 1$.

7 State the vertex of $y = |2x + 6|$.

8 State the vertex of $y = |x| - 2$.

9 Solve $|x - 1| = |x + 3|$.

10 State the gradient of $y = |x|$ for $x > 0$.

Challenge

HARD 10 questions

Letters in place of numbers, and more than one idea at once.

1 Solve $|x - 2| + |x + 1| = 5$.

2 Solve $|2x - 1| = x + 2$.

3 Solve $|x^2 - 4| = 0$.

4 Solve $|x|^2 - 3|x| + 2 = 0$.

5 Solve $|x - 1| < 2x$.

6 Find the two one-sided derivatives of $y = |x|$ at $x = 0$.

7 Show that $\frac{d}{dx}|x| = \frac{x}{|x|}$ for $x \neq 0$.

8 Solve $|x + 2| = |2x - 1|$.

9 State the x-coordinates of the corners of $y = |x^2 - 1|$.

10 Solve $|x| + x = 6$.

Beyond

VERY HARD

15 questions

Olympiad work. Expect to spend real time on these — some need an idea, not just a method.

1 Solve $|x - 1| + |x - 3| = 2$.

2 Solve $|x - 1| + |x - 3| = 1$.

3 Solve $|x - 1| + |x - 3| = 6$.

4 Prove the triangle inequality $|a + b| \leq |a| + |b|$.

5 Prove that $||a| - |b|| \leq |a - b|$.

6 $f(x) = x|x|$. Show that f is differentiable everywhere, but that $f''(0)$ does not exist.

7 Solve $|x^2 - 5x + 4| = x^2 - 5x + 4$.

8 Find the least value of $f(x) = |x - 1| + |x - 2| + |x - 3|$.

9 Describe the graph of $y = |x| + |x - 2|$, and say where it is constant.

10 Solve $|x - 1| = x - 1$.

11 Solve $|x - 1| + |x + 1| \le 4$.

12 Explain why $\sqrt{x^2} = |x|$ and not x.

13 Find every a for which the graph of $y = |x - a|$ passes through $(1, 3)$.

14 Show that $|x|$ is continuous at $x = 0$ but not differentiable there.

15 Solve $|x - 2| < |x + 1|$.

The equations of the tangent and the normal

One point and one gradient fix a line — and the normal is its perpendicular at the same point.

Lessons 17–18 · Algebra and Calculus 11, §1.6 · Pure Mathematics 1, 7.8 · 45 questions

KEY WORDS

- tangent
- normal
- point of tangency
- gradient of a tangent
- perpendicular gradients
- point-gradient form
- horizontal tangent
- intercept

REMEMBER

1. Tangent at $x = a$: $y - f(a) = f'(a)(x - a)$.
2. Normal gradient is $-\dfrac{1}{f'(a)}$, through the same point.
3. Find $f(a)$ and $f'(a)$ before writing a line down. Two numbers, then one formula.
4. If $f'(a) = 0$ the tangent is horizontal, $y = f(a)$, and the normal is vertical, $x = a$.
5. Perpendicular gradients multiply to -1.

Focus

EASY · 10 questions

The basic skill, one step at a time.

1. $y = x^2$. Find the tangent gradient at $x = 2$.

2. $y = x^2$. Find the tangent at $(2, 4)$.

3. $y = x^2$. Find the normal gradient at $x = 2$.

4. $y = x^3$. Find the tangent gradient at $x = 1$.

5. $y = 3x + 1$. Find the tangent at $(0, 1)$.

6. $y = x^2$. Find where the tangent is horizontal.

7 $y = x^2 - 4x$. Find the tangent gradient at $x = 1$.

8 A line has gradient 2. Find the gradient of a line perpendicular to it.

9 $y = \frac{1}{x}$. Find the tangent gradient at $x = 1$.

10 $y = x^2$. Find the normal at $(0, 0)$.

Practice

MEDIUM 10 questions

The same skill with more to simplify first.

1 $y = x^2 + 1$. Find the tangent at $(1, 2)$.

2 $y = x^3 - x$. Find the tangent at $(1, 0)$.

3 $y = \sqrt{x}$. Find the tangent at $(4, 2)$.

4 $y = \frac{1}{x}$. Find the tangent at $(1, 1)$.

5 $y = x^2$. Find the normal at $(1, 1)$.

6 $y = x^2 - 2x$. Find the normal at $(2, 0)$.

7 $y = x^3$. Find every point at which the tangent gradient is 3.

8 $y = x^2 + 3x$. Find where the tangent is horizontal.

9 $y = 2x^2$. Find the tangent at $(1, 2)$.

10 Find the y-intercept of the tangent to $y = x^2$ at $(3, 9)$.

Challenge

HARD 10 questions

Letters in place of numbers, and more than one idea at once.

1 $y = x^2$. The tangent at $x = a$ passes through $(0, -4)$. Find a.

2 $y = \frac{1}{x}$. Find the tangent at $(2, \frac{1}{2})$.

3 $y = x^3 - 3x$. Find the tangents parallel to the x-axis.

4 $y = \sqrt{x}$. Find the normal at $(1, 1)$.

5 $y = x^2$. Find the point at which the normal has gradient 1.

6 $y = x^2 - 4$. The tangent at $x = 1$ meets the x-axis. Find where.

7 $y = \dfrac{x + 1}{x - 1}$. Find the tangent gradient at $x = 2$.

8 $y = x^3$. The tangent at $(1, 1)$ meets the curve again. Find that point.

9 Find the area of the triangle the tangent to $y = x^2$ at $(2, 4)$ cuts from the axes.

10 $y = x^2 + bx$. The tangent at $x = 0$ has gradient 3. Find b.

Beyond

VERY HARD · 15 questions

Olympiad work. Expect to spend real time on these — some need an idea, not just a method.

1 Find the equations of both tangents to $y = x^2$ that pass through $(0, -1)$.

2 $y = x^2$. Find where the normal at $(1, 1)$ meets the curve again.

3 The tangent to $y = \frac{1}{x}$ at $(a, \frac{1}{a})$, with $a > 0$, cuts the axes at A and B. Show that the area of triangle OAB does not depend on a.

4 Show that the point of tangency is the midpoint of the part of the tangent cut off by the axes, for $y = \frac{1}{x}$.

5 Find c for which the line $y = x + c$ is a tangent to $y = x^2$.

6 Find every m for which $y = mx - 1$ is a tangent to $y = x^2$.

7 The tangent and the normal to $y = x^2$ at $(1, 1)$ meet the y-axis at P and Q. Find the length PQ.

8 Show that the tangent to $y = x^3$ at $x = a$ meets the curve again at $x = -2a$.

9 Find the points of $y = x^3 - 3x$ at which the tangent is parallel to $y = 9x$.

10 The curves $y = x^2$ and $y = \sqrt{x}$ meet at $(1, 1)$. Find the angle between them there.

11 Do $y = x^2$ and $y = \frac{1}{x}$ cut at right angles where they meet?

12 Find k for which $y = x^2 + k$ touches the line $y = 2x$.

13 The normal to $y = x^2$ at (a, a^2), with $a \neq 0$, meets the y-axis at $(0, b)$. Find b in terms of a.

14 Show that the normal to $y = x^2$ at (a, a^2), with $a \neq 0$, meets the curve again at $x = -a - \frac{1}{2a}$.

15 Find every point of $y = x^3$ at which the tangent passes through $(0, 2)$.

Investigating a function with the derivative

Where a curve rises, where it falls, where it turns — and the sign chart that settles all three.

Lessons 19–22 · Algebra and Calculus 11, §1.7 · Pure Mathematics 1, 8.1–8.2 · 45 questions

KEY WORDS

- increasing function
- decreasing function
- stationary point
- critical point
- local maximum
- local minimum
- point of inflection
- sign chart
- curve sketching

REMEMBER

1. $f' > 0$ on an interval means increasing there; $f' < 0$ means decreasing.
2. Stationary points are the solutions of $f'(x) = 0$.
3. First derivative test: + then − is a maximum, − then + a minimum, no change an inflection.
4. Second derivative test at a stationary point: $f'' < 0$ maximum, $f'' > 0$ minimum, $f'' = 0$ tells you nothing — go back to the sign chart.
5. $f'' > 0$ is concave up and $f'' < 0$ concave down; an inflection needs f'' to change sign, not merely to vanish.

Focus

EASY · 10 questions

The basic skill, one step at a time.

1. $y = x^2 - 4x$. Find the stationary point.

2. $y = x^2 - 4x$. State whether it is a maximum or a minimum.

3. $y = x^3 - 3x$. Find $\dfrac{dy}{dx}$.

4. $y = x^3 - 3x$. Find the stationary points.

5. $y = x^2$. State where it is increasing.

6. $y = 4 - x^2$. State where it is decreasing.

7 $y = x^2 + 2x$. Find $\frac{d^2y}{dx^2}$.

8 $y = x^3$. Find $\frac{d^2y}{dx^2}$.

9 $y = x^3$. Find where $\frac{d^2y}{dx^2} = 0$.

10 State the nature of the stationary point of $y = 5 - x^2$.

Practice

MEDIUM 10 questions

The same skill with more to simplify first.

1 $y = x^3 - 3x^2$. Find the stationary points.

2 $y = x^3 - 3x^2$. Classify each stationary point.

3 $y = x^3 - 3x^2$. Find the point of inflection.

4 $y = 2x^3 - 9x^2 + 12x$. Find the stationary points.

5 State where $y = x^3 - 12x$ is increasing.

6 $y = x^4 - 2x^2$. Find the stationary points.

7 $y = x + \frac{1}{x}$. Find the stationary points.

8 $y = x + \frac{1}{x}$. State the nature of the stationary point at $x = 1$.

9 $y = x^2(x - 3)$. Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$.

10 Find the greatest value of $y = 6x - x^2$.

Challenge

HARD 10 questions

Letters in place of numbers, and more than one idea at once.

1 $y = x^3 - 6x^2 + 9x$. Find and classify every stationary point.

2 $y = x^3 - 6x^2 + 9x$. Find the point of inflection.

3 $y = \frac{x}{x^2 + 1}$. Find the stationary points.

4 $y = x^4 - 4x^3$. Find the stationary points.

5 $y = x^4 - 4x^3$. State the nature of the stationary point at $x = 0$.

6 Find the greatest and least values of $y = x^3 - 3x$ on $[0, 2]$.

7 $y = \dfrac{x - 1}{x + 1}$. State whether it is increasing or decreasing.

8 Show that $y = x^3 + x$ is increasing for every x.

9 $y = x^4 + 4x$. Find and classify the stationary point.

10 Find every a for which $y = x^3 + ax$ has no stationary point.

Beyond

VERY HARD · 15 questions

Olympiad work. Expect to spend real time on these — some need an idea, not just a method.

1 $y = x^3 + ax^2 + bx$ has stationary points at $x = 1$ and $x = 3$. Find a and b.

2 Show that a cubic has either two stationary points or none, apart from the borderline case of one repeated.

3 $y = x^4 - 4x^3 + 10$. Find and classify every stationary point.

4 Prove that a differentiable function is monotonic between two consecutive stationary points.

5 Find the least value of $y = x + \frac{1}{x}$ for $x > 0$.

6 Deduce from the previous question that $x + \frac{1}{x} \geq 2$ for every $x > 0$, and state when equality holds.

7 Show that $y = ax^3 + bx^2 + cx + d$ has its point of inflection at $x = -\frac{b}{3a}$.

8 Find the greatest value of $y = x^2(3 - x)$ on $[0, 3]$.

9 Find the greatest and least values of $y = \frac{x}{x^2 + 1}$ over all real x.

10 Show that $f(x) = x^3 - 3x^2 + 3x - 1$ has exactly one stationary point and no maximum or minimum.

11 $y = x^3 + px + q$ has a stationary point lying on the x-axis. Find the relation between p and q.

12 Show that if $f''(x) > 0$ for every x, then f has at most one stationary point.

13 $y = \dfrac{x^2 + 1}{x}$. Find the stationary points and their nature.

14 Find the number of real roots of $x^3 - 3x + k = 0$, in terms of k.

15 Prove that a polynomial of degree n has at most $n - 1$ stationary points.

Extremum problems

Name the quantity, write the constraint, eliminate, differentiate — and then justify.

Lessons 23–25 · Algebra and Calculus 11, §1.8 · Pure Mathematics 1, 8.3 · 45 questions

KEY WORDS

- extremum
- greatest value
- least value
- constraint
- objective function
- feasible domain
- endpoint value
- optimisation
- justification

REMEMBER

1. Write the quantity to be made greatest or least, then the constraint relating the variables.
2. Eliminate until one variable is left, and state its feasible domain — lengths are positive.
3. Solve $f' = 0$, then justify the nature with f'' or a sign chart. An unjustified answer is an unearned one.
4. On a closed interval, compare the critical values with the value at each endpoint.
5. Answer the question actually asked, with units. The value of x is rarely what was wanted.

Focus

EASY · 10 questions

The basic skill, one step at a time.

1. Two numbers add to 10. Find their greatest product.

2. Find the greatest value of $y = x(10 - x)$.

3. A rectangle has perimeter 20 cm. Find its greatest area.

4. Find the least value of $x^2 + 4$.

5. Find the greatest value of $9 - x^2$.

6. Find the least value of $x^2 - 6x$.

7 Find x for which $x + x^2$ is least.

8 Find the least value of $(x - 2)^2 + 3$.

9 Find the greatest value of $y = 8x - x^2$.

10 Find the least value of $y = x^2 + 2x + 5$.

Practice

MEDIUM 10 questions

The same skill with more to simplify first.

1 Two numbers add to 12. Find the least possible sum of their squares.

2 A rectangle has perimeter 36 cm. Find its greatest area.

3 Two positive numbers have product 36. Find their least sum.

4 A rectangle has area 64 cm². Find its least perimeter.

5 Find the least value of $x + \dfrac{9}{x}$ for $x > 0$.

6 Find the greatest value of $y = x(6 - x)$ on $[0, 4]$.

7 Find the least value of $y = x^2 + \frac{16}{x}$ for $x > 0$.

8 A box has a square base of edge x and volume 32 cm³. Find x for least total surface area.

9 A farmer has 100 m of fence for a rectangular pen against a straight wall, using the wall as one side. Find the greatest area.

10 Find the least value of $y = (x - 1)^2 + (x - 3)^2$.

Challenge

HARD 10 questions

Letters in place of numbers, and more than one idea at once.

1 Squares of side x are cut from the corners of a 12 cm square sheet and the sides folded up. Find the greatest volume.

2 Find the greatest area of a rectangle inscribed in a semicircle of radius r, with one side on the diameter.

3 Find the greatest area of a rectangle with its base on the x-axis and its top corners on $y = 4 - x^2$.

4 A closed cylinder has volume 1000 cm³. Find the radius giving least total surface area.

5 Find the point of $y = x^2$ nearest to $(0, 3)$.

6 A wire of length 100 cm is cut in two; one piece forms a square and the other a circle. Find the length of the square piece for least total area.

7 Find the least value of $f(x) = x^2 + \dfrac{1}{x^2}$ for $x > 0$.

8 A rectangular field beside a straight river is fenced on three sides with 240 m of fence. Find the greatest area.

9 Find the greatest value of $y = x(a - x)^2$ on $[0, a]$, for $a > 0$.

10 Find the point of the line $y = 2x + 3$ nearest to the origin.

Beyond VERY HARD 15 questions

Olympiad work. Expect to spend real time on these — some need an idea, not just a method.

1 Find the greatest volume of a cone inscribed in a sphere of radius R.

2 Find the greatest volume of a cylinder inscribed in a sphere of radius R.

3 An open cylinder — no lid — has volume V. Show that the least surface area occurs when the height equals the radius.

4 Two corridors of widths a and b meet at a right angle. Find the length of the longest ladder that can be carried round the corner, kept horizontal.

5 Light travels at speed v_1 in one medium and v_2 in another. Show that the path of least time obeys $\dfrac{\sin\theta_1}{v_1} = \dfrac{\sin\theta_2}{v_2}$.

6 Find the greatest area of a rectangle inscribed in a right-angled triangle with legs a and b, the rectangle sharing the right angle.

7 Find the point of $y = x^2$ nearest to $(0, 2)$, and the shortest distance.

8 Find the greatest value of $f(x) = x^2(1 - x)^3$ on $[0, 1]$.

9 An open box with a square base has volume V. Find the base edge giving least surface area.

10 Two sides of a triangle have fixed lengths a and b. Find the greatest possible area.

11 Use calculus to prove that $\frac{a + b}{2} \geq \sqrt{ab}$ for positive a and b.

12 A rectangular beam is cut from a circular log of diameter d. Its strength is proportional to the width times the square of the depth. Find the strongest beam.

13 Prove that among all rectangles of a given perimeter the square has the greatest area.

14 Find the dimensions of the cylinder of greatest volume that can be inscribed in a cone of base radius R and height H.

15 A window is a rectangle surmounted by a semicircle. Its perimeter is 10 m. Find the greatest possible area.

Revision · Control work 2 — applications of the derivative

Tangents, monotonicity, turning points and optimisation together — the whole of Unit 2, and the quarter.

Lessons 26–27 · Control work 2 and the quarter review · 45 questions

KEY WORDS

- tangent
- normal
- stationary point
- maximum
- minimum
- point of inflection
- optimisation
- sign chart
- justification

REMEMBER

1. A tangent or a normal needs $f(a)$ and $f'(a)$ first — two numbers, then one formula.
2. Stationary points come from $f' = 0$; classify them with f'' or a sign chart.
3. On a closed interval, the greatest value may sit at an endpoint rather than at a turning point.
4. In an optimisation problem, state the feasible domain and justify the extremum.
5. Check the answer for sense. A negative length, or a maximum below an endpoint value, means a slip.

Focus

EASY · 10 questions

The basic skill, one step at a time.

1. $y = x^2$. Find the tangent at $(1, 1)$.

2. $y = x^2 - 2x$. Find the stationary point.

3. $y = x^2 - 2x$. State its nature.

4. $y = x^3 - 12x$. Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$.

5. Find the greatest value of $y = 10 - x^2$.

6 $y = x^3$. Find the normal gradient at $x = 1$.

7 State where $y = x^2$ is decreasing.

8 Two numbers add to 8. Find their greatest product.

9 $y = x^2 + 1$. Find $\frac{d^2y}{dx^2}$.

10 Find the least value of $y = x^2 + 6x + 10$.

Practice

MEDIUM 10 questions

The same skill with more to simplify first.

1 $y = x^3 - 6x^2 + 9x$. Find the stationary points.

2 $y = x^3 - 6x^2 + 9x$. Classify them.

3 $y = 2x^3 - 9x^2$. Find the point of inflection.

4 $y = \frac{2}{x}$. Find the tangent at $(1, 2)$.

5 A rectangle has perimeter 40 cm. Find its greatest area.

6 Find the greatest value of $y = x(4 - x)$.

7 $y = x^4 - 4x^2$. Find the stationary points.

8 $y = \sqrt{x}$. Find the normal at $(4, 2)$.

9 State where $y = x^3 - 3x^2$ is increasing.

10 Find the least value of $y = x + \frac{4}{x}$ for $x > 0$.

Challenge

HARD 10 questions

Letters in place of numbers, and more than one idea at once.

1 $y = x^3 - 3x^2 + 2$. Find and classify every stationary point.

2 Find the greatest and least values of $y = x^3 - 3x$ on $[-2, 3]$.

3 The tangent to $y = x^2$ at (a, a^2) passes through $(1, 0)$. Find a.

4 Squares of side x are cut from the corners of an 18 cm square sheet and the sides folded up. Find the greatest volume.

5 $y = \dfrac{x + 1}{x - 2}$. Find the tangent gradient at $x = 3$.

6 Find a so that $y = x^3 + ax^2$ has a point of inflection at $x = 1$.

7 A closed cylinder has volume 500 cm³. Find the radius giving least surface area.

8 Show that $y = \dfrac{x}{x + 1}$ is increasing on each of its branches.

9 Find the greatest area of a rectangle inscribed in a semicircle of radius 4, with one side on the diameter.

10 Find the greatest value of $y = x^2(6 - x)$ on $[0, 6]$.

Beyond VERY HARD 15 questions

Olympiad work. Expect to spend real time on these — some need an idea, not just a method.

1 $y = x^3 + ax^2 + bx + c$ has a maximum at $x = -1$, a minimum at $x = 3$, and passes through $(0, 5)$. Find a, b and c.

2 Find the number of real roots of $x^3 - 3x = k$, in terms of k.

3 Find the shortest distance from the origin to the line $y = x + 2$.

4 The tangent and the normal to $y = x^2$ at (a, a^2), with $a > 0$, meet the y-axis. Find the area of the triangle they form with it.

5 Find the greatest area of a rectangle inscribed in the ellipse $\frac{x^2}{a^2} + \frac{y^2}{b^2} = 1$, with sides parallel to the axes.

6 Prove that of all rectangles with a given diagonal, the square has the greatest area.

7 Show that $f(x) = x^3 + px + q$ is increasing for every x exactly when $p \geq 0$.

8 $y = x^4 - 8x^2$. Find and classify every stationary point.

9 A particle moves with $s = t^3 - 6t^2 + 9t$. Find the total distance travelled in the first 4 seconds.

10 Prove that the point of inflection of a cubic is the mean of its two stationary points, whenever those exist.

11 Find the greatest area of a triangle inscribed in a circle of radius R.

12 Show that $f(x) = x + \sin x$ is increasing for every x.

13 $y = ax^3 + bx^2$ has a stationary point at $(2, 4)$. Find a and b.

14 Show that among all cylinders of a given total surface area, the one of greatest volume has its height equal to its diameter.

15 Show that the tangents to $y = x^2$ at $x = a$ and $x = b$, with $a \neq b$, meet at the point $(\frac{a + b}{2}, ab)$.

Answers

Topic 1 · Increments, and the problem of the tangent

Focus · easy

1. 9
2. 15
3. 5
4. 1
5. $6h + h^2$
6. $6 + h$
7. 0
8. 4
9. 4
10. 60 km/h

Practice · medium

1. $h^2 + 4h$
2. $h + 4$
3. $-\dfrac{h}{2(2+h)}$
4. $-\dfrac{1}{2(2+h)}$
5. $3h + 3h^2 + h^3$
6. $3 + 3h + h^2$
7. $-\dfrac{1}{2}$
8. 4
9. 5
10. $\sqrt{4+h} - 2$

Challenge · hard

1. $2a + h$
2. $-\dfrac{2+h}{(1+h)^2}$
3. $\dfrac{1}{\sqrt{a+h}+\sqrt{a}}$
4. $2ax + b + ah$
5. $h = 1$
6. $-\dfrac{1}{ab}$
7. $10 + 5h$
8. 10 — the speed at the instant $t = 1$
9. $3a^2 + 3ah + h^2$
10. $\dfrac{h}{h+1}$

Beyond · very hard

1 na^{n-1}

By the binomial theorem $(a+h)^n = a^n + na^{n-1}h + \dfrac{n(n-1)}{2}a^{n-2}h^2 + \ldots + h^n$. Subtracting a^n and dividing by h leaves $na^{n-1} + \dfrac{n(n-1)}{2}a^{n-2}h + \ldots + h^{n-1}$. Every term after the first carries a factor h, so as $h \to 0$ they all vanish and the quotient tends to na^{n-1}.

2 $x = 2$

The secant gradient is $\dfrac{9-1}{3-1} = 4$. The tangent gradient at $x = c$ is $2c$, so $2c = 4$ and $c = 2$, which lies in $(1, 3)$. This is the mean value theorem in its simplest case.

3 True for every quadratic

Let $f(x) = px^2 + qx + r$. Then $f(b) - f(a) = p(b^2 - a^2) + q(b - a) = (b - a)[p(a + b) + q]$, so the secant gradient is $p(a + b) + q$. The tangent gradient at $x = c$ is $2pc + q$, and $2pc + q = p(a + b) + q$ gives $c = \dfrac{a+b}{2}$.

4 $c = \sqrt{ab}$

The secant gradient is $-\frac{1}{ab}$ from Challenge 6. The tangent gradient at $x = c$ is $-\frac{1}{c^2}$, so $c^2 = ab$ and $c = \sqrt{ab}$, the geometric mean. It lies between a and b because $a < \sqrt{ab} < b$ whenever $0 < a < b$.

5 0; no tangent at the corner

$f(1) = f(-1) = 1$, so $\Delta y = 0$ and the average rate of change is 0. At $x = 0$ the quotient $\frac{|h| - 0}{h}$ equals 1 for $h > 0$ and -1 for $h < 0$. The two one-sided limits disagree, so the secant has no single limiting position and no tangent exists.

6 a^2

$f(a) - f(-a) = a^3 - (-a)^3 = 2a^3$, and the run is $a - (-a) = 2a$. The gradient is $\frac{2a^3}{2a} = a^2$, for every $a \neq 0$.

7 $2p$

$\frac{q^2 - p^2}{q - p} = \frac{(q - p)(q + p)}{q - p} = p + q$. Letting $q \to p$ slides the second point onto the first, and the secant gradient $p + q$ tends to $2p$. So the tangent gradient at $x = p$ is $2p$.

8 $a = -1$

By Challenge 1 with $h = 2$ the secant gradient is $2a + 2$. Setting $2a + 2 = 0$ gives $a = -1$, so the interval is $[-1, 1]$ — symmetric about the vertex, which is the only way a parabola can return to the same height.

9 $3h + h^2$; limit 0 — the point is at rest at $t = 1$

$s(1) = -2$ and $s(1 + h) = (1 + h)^3 - 3(1 + h) = -2 + 3h^2 + h^3$. So $\Delta s = 3h^2 + h^3$ and $\frac{\Delta s}{h} = 3h + h^2$, which tends to 0. The point is momentarily at rest at $t = 1$, where it turns round.

10 $\frac{1}{\sqrt{a} + \sqrt{b}}$

The gradient is $\frac{\sqrt{b} - \sqrt{a}}{b - a}$. Multiply numerator and denominator by the conjugate $\sqrt{b} + \sqrt{a}$: the numerator becomes $b - a$, which cancels with the denominator and leaves $\frac{1}{\sqrt{a} + \sqrt{b}}$.

11 Both equal $2t + 2$

The secant gradient is $2t + 2$ by Challenge 1 with $h = 2$. The tangent gradient at $x = t + 1$ is $2(t + 1) = 2t + 2$. They agree — the midpoint property of question 3 again.

12 $b = -3$

$f(0) = 0$ and $f(4) = 16 + 4b$, so the secant gradient is $\frac{16 + 4b}{4} = 4 + b$. Setting $4 + b = 1$ gives $b = -3$.

13 Always negative

The gradient is $-\frac{1}{ab}$. With $a > 0$ and $b > 0$ the product ab is positive, so $-\frac{1}{ab} < 0$. Geometrically the branch in the first quadrant falls everywhere, so every chord of it slopes downwards.

14 $f(x) = x^2 + x$

The average rate of change is $\frac{f(x) - f(0)}{x - 0} = \frac{f(x)}{x}$. Setting this equal to $x + 1$ gives $f(x) = x(x + 1) = x^2 + x$. Checking: $f(0) = 0$, as required.

15 4 — the same limit

$f(2 + h) = 4 + 4h + h^2$ and $f(2 - h) = 4 - 4h + h^2$, so the numerator is $8h$ and the quotient is exactly 4 for every $h \neq 0$. The limit is 4, the same as the ordinary quotient gives. This symmetric quotient straddles the point instead of leaning to one side, which is why it is the one a calculator uses.

Topic 2 · The limit of a function

Focus · easy

1 7

2 -4

3 6

4 2

5 $-\dfrac{1}{4}$

6 2

7 5

8 0

9 12

10 1

Practice · medium

1 1

2 $\dfrac{1}{6}$

3 3

4 0

5 The limit does not exist — the quotient grows without bound

6 1

7 $\dfrac{3}{2}$

8 -1

9 4

10 3

Challenge · hard

1 $\dfrac{5}{2}$

2 $\dfrac{1}{2}$

3 0

4 $\dfrac{1}{2}$

5 1

6 $\dfrac{9}{4}$

7 e

8 1

9 $a = 4$

10 -1 and 1; the limit does not exist

Beyond · very hard

1 $\dfrac{1}{3}$

Put $u = (1+x)^{1/3}$, so $u^3 = 1 + x$ and $x = u^3 - 1$. As $x \to 0$, $u \to 1$. The quotient becomes $\dfrac{u-1}{u^3-1} = \dfrac{u-1}{(u-1)(u^2+u+1)} = \dfrac{1}{u^2+u+1}$, which tends to $\dfrac{1}{3}$.

2 n

$x^n - 1 = (x-1)(x^{n-1} + x^{n-2} + \ldots + x + 1)$. Cancelling $x - 1$ leaves a sum of n terms, each tending to 1 as $x \to 1$, so the limit is n. Notice this is the derivative of x^n at $x = 1$.

3 $\dfrac{a}{b}$

Write the quotient as $\dfrac{\sin ax}{ax} \cdot \dfrac{bx}{\sin bx} \cdot \dfrac{a}{b}$. The first factor tends to 1 and the second to 1, leaving $\dfrac{a}{b}$.

4 $\frac{1}{2}$

Multiply by the conjugate: $\frac{x}{\sqrt{x^2+x}+x}$. Divide top and bottom by x (positive, so $x=\sqrt{x^2}$): $\frac{1}{\sqrt{1+1/x}+1}$, which tends to $\frac{1}{2}$.

5 $\frac{1}{2}$

$\tan x-\sin x=\sin x(\frac{1}{\cos x}-1)=\frac{\sin x(1-\cos x)}{\cos x}$. Dividing by x^3 gives $\frac{\sin x}{x}\cdot\frac{1-\cos x}{x^2}\cdot\frac{1}{\cos x}$, which tends to $1\cdot\frac{1}{2}\cdot 1=\frac{1}{2}$.

6 2

Use $1-\cos 2x=2\sin^2 x$. The quotient becomes $\frac{2\sin^2 x}{x\cdot\sin x}=\frac{2\sin x}{x}$, which tends to 2.

7 $\frac{1}{4}$

Multiply by the conjugate $\sqrt{x+2}+2$. The numerator becomes $(x+2)-4=x-2$, which cancels the denominator and leaves $\frac{1}{\sqrt{x+2}+2}$, tending to $\frac{1}{4}$.

8 e

Put $t=\frac{1}{x}$. As $x\to 0^+$, $t\to\infty$, and $(1+x)^{1/x}$ becomes $(1+\frac{1}{t})^t$, whose limit is e. The same substitution handles $x\to 0^-$ with $t\to-\infty$, and that limit is e too. They are the same limit written in two variables.

9 0

For every $x\neq 0$, $-1\le\sin\frac{1}{x}\le 1$, so $-|x|\le x\cdot\sin\frac{1}{x}\le|x|$. Both bounds tend to 0 as $x\to 0$, so the middle expression is squeezed to 0. Note that $\sin\frac{1}{x}$ itself has no limit at 0 — the factor x is what kills the oscillation.

10 1

Put $t=\frac{1}{x}$, so $t\to 0$ as $x\to\infty$. The expression becomes $\frac{\sin t}{t}$, whose limit is 1. Contrast with the previous question: the same two factors, opposite limits.

11 $a=1,\ b=-1$

Divide: $\frac{x^2+1}{x+1}=x-1+\frac{2}{x+1}$. Subtracting $ax+b$ leaves $(1-a)x-(1+b)+\frac{2}{x+1}$. The last term vanishes on its own, so the limit is 0 exactly when $1-a=0$ and $1+b=0$. The line $y=x-1$ is the oblique asymptote.

12 -1

Since $1-x^3=(1-x)(1+x+x^2)$, the common denominator is $(1-x)(1+x+x^2)$ and the numerator becomes $(1+x+x^2)-3=x^2+x-2=(x+2)(x-1)$. So the expression is $\frac{(x+2)(x-1)}{-(x-1)(1+x+x^2)}=-\frac{x+2}{1+x+x^2}$, which tends to $-\frac{3}{3}=-1$.

13 $\dfrac{3}{2}$

Divide numerator and denominator by x. The numerator over x tends to 1 by Challenge 5. For the denominator, question 1 gives $\dfrac{(1+x)^{1/3}-1}{x} \to \dfrac{1}{3}$, and the same with $-x$ gives $\dfrac{1-(1-x)^{1/3}}{x} \to \dfrac{1}{3}$; adding, the denominator over x tends to $\dfrac{2}{3}$. The limit is $1 \div \dfrac{2}{3} = \dfrac{3}{2}$.

14 $\dfrac{\pi}{180}$

An angle of x degrees is $\dfrac{\pi x}{180}$ radians, so $\sin x° = \sin\dfrac{\pi x}{180}$. Then $\dfrac{\sin x°}{x} = \dfrac{\pi}{180} \cdot \dfrac{\sin(\pi x/180)}{\pi x/180}$, and the second factor tends to 1. The limit is $\dfrac{\pi}{180} \approx 0.01745$. This is exactly why calculus insists on radians: only there does the constant come out as 1.

15 Both limits are 2

Near $x = 1$ we have $x > 0$, so $|x| = x$ and $f(x) = \dfrac{(x-1)(x+1)}{x-1} = x + 1 \to 2$. Near $x = -1$ we have $x < 0$, so $|x| = -x$ and $f(x) = \dfrac{(x-1)(x+1)}{-(x+1)} = 1 - x \to 2$. Both points are removable discontinuities, and both would be repaired by the value 2.

Topic 3 · The derivative of a function

Focus · easy

1 0

2 4

3 3

4 $2x$

5 10

6 $3x^2$

7 $2x$

8 6

9 8

10 $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = 2x$

Practice · medium

1 $4x - 3$

2 $-\dfrac{1}{x^2}$

3 $-\dfrac{1}{4}$

4 $\dfrac{1}{2\sqrt{x}}$

5 $\dfrac{1}{6}$

6 $x = 2$

7 -1

8 8

9 11

10 $-\dfrac{2}{x^3}$

Challenge · hard

1 $-\dfrac{1}{(x+1)^2}$

6 0

7 $-\dfrac{1}{2x\sqrt{x}}$

2 $\dfrac{1}{2\sqrt{x+3}}$

3 $2ax + b$

4 $4x^3$

5 The one-sided derivatives are 1 and -1

8 $t = 0$ and $t = 4$

9 $x = 3.5$

10 $x = 2$ and $x = -2$

Beyond · very hard

1 nx^{n-1}

Expand $(x+h)^n$ by the binomial theorem, subtract x^n and divide by h: the result is $nx^{n-1} + \dfrac{n(n-1)}{2}x^{n-2}h + \dots + h^{n-1}$. Every term beyond the first carries a factor h and vanishes as $h \to 0$, leaving nx^{n-1}.

2 $\dfrac{1}{3x^{2/3}}$

Write $a = (x+h)^{1/3}$ and $b = x^{1/3}$, so $a^3 - b^3 = h$. Using $a^3 - b^3 = (a-b)(a^2+ab+b^2)$, the quotient $\dfrac{a-b}{h}$ equals $\dfrac{1}{a^2+ab+b^2}$. As $h \to 0$ we get $a \to b$, so the denominator tends to $3b^2 = 3x^{2/3}$.

3 $\cos x$

$\sin(x+h) - \sin x = \sin x \cdot \cos h + \cos x \cdot \sin h - \sin x$. Dividing by h gives $\cos x \cdot \dfrac{\sin h}{h} - \sin x \cdot \dfrac{1-\cos h}{h}$. The first factor tends to 1 and the second to 0, so the limit is $\cos x$.

4 $-\sin x$

$\cos(x+h) - \cos x = \cos x \cdot \cos h - \sin x \cdot \sin h - \cos x$. Dividing by h gives $-\sin x \cdot \dfrac{\sin h}{h} - \cos x \cdot \dfrac{1-\cos h}{h}$, which tends to $-\sin x$. The minus sign is the one every class loses.

5 Differentiability implies continuity

Write $f(x) - f(a) = \dfrac{f(x)-f(a)}{x-a} \cdot (x-a)$ for $x \neq a$. As $x \to a$ the first factor tends to $f'(a)$, a finite number, and the second tends to 0. The product tends to 0, so $f(x) \to f(a)$, which is continuity.

6 Yes, and $f'(1) = 2$

Both pieces give $f(1) = 1$, so f is continuous. The left derivative is $2x$ at $x = 1$, that is 2; the right derivative is 2. They agree, so $f'(1) = 2$. The line is exactly the tangent to the parabola at that point, which is why the join is smooth.

7 No — continuous but not differentiable

Both pieces give $f(1) = 1$, so f is continuous at 1. But the left derivative is 2 and the right derivative is 3. They disagree, so there is a corner and no derivative. Continuity is not enough.

8 0

The quotient is $\dfrac{h^2 \sin(1/h) - 0}{h} = h \cdot \sin\dfrac{1}{h}$, and that is squeezed to 0 between $-|h|$ and $|h|$. So $f'(0) = 0$, even though f' itself oscillates wildly near 0 and has no limit there.

9 $a = 4$, $b = -4$

Matching the derivatives gives $a = 2(2) = 4$. Matching the values gives $4 = 2a + b = 8 + b$, so $b = -4$. The line is $y = 4x - 4$, the tangent to $y = x^2$ at $(2, 4)$ — the only line that can join on smoothly.

10 $a = 1$ and $a = -1$

The tangent at $x = a$ is $y - a^2 = 2a(x-a)$, that is $y = 2ax - a^2$. Putting $x = 0$ gives $y = -a^2$, and this must equal -1, so $a^2 = 1$ and $a = \pm 1$. Two tangents pass through that point.

11 Only at $(0, 0)$

A horizontal tangent needs $f'(x) = 3x^2 = 0$, so $x = 0$ and the point is $(0, 0)$. This is a stationary point that is not a maximum or a minimum — the curve flattens and then carries on rising, which is a stationary point of inflection.

12 $f'(x) = 2|x|$

For $x > 0$, $f(x) = x^2$ and $f'(x) = 2x = 2|x|$. For $x < 0$, $f(x) = -x^2$ and $f'(x) = -2x = 2|x|$. At 0 the quotient is $\frac{h|h|}{h} = |h| \to 0 = 2|0|$. So the formula holds everywhere, and f' is continuous — unlike $|x|$ itself, this function is smooth at the origin.

13 $v = 3t^2 - 6t$; at rest at $t = 0$ and $t = 2$

Differentiating gives $v(t) = 3t^2 - 6t = 3t(t - 2)$, which is zero at $t = 0$ and $t = 2$. Between those instants $v < 0$, so the particle moves backwards before turning round again at $t = 2$.

14 No derivative — a cusp

$f(x) = x^{2/3}$, so the quotient at 0 is $\frac{h^{2/3}}{h} = h^{-1/3}$. As $h \to 0^+$ this tends to $+\infty$ and as $h \to 0^-$ to $-\infty$. The two sides run off in opposite directions: the curve has a vertical cusp at the origin, not a tangent of finite gradient.

15 It touches only at $x = a$

The tangent is $y = 2ax - a^2$. Setting $x^2 = 2ax - a^2$ gives $x^2 - 2ax + a^2 = (x - a)^2 = 0$, whose only root is $x = a$, repeated. The repeated root is the algebraic signature of touching rather than crossing — and it is special to the parabola, since a tangent to a cubic generally does meet it again.

Topic 4 · The rules of differentiation

Focus · easy

1 $5x^4$

2 $12x^3$

3 $2x + 1$

4 0

5 $-3x^{-4}$

6 $\frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}}$

7 $-\frac{1}{x^2}$

8 $12x^2 - 4x$

9 $5x^4$

10 3

Practice · medium

1 $2x + 3$

2 $3x^2 - 6x$

3 $1 - \frac{1}{x^2}$

4 $\frac{3\sqrt{x}}{2}$

5 $-\frac{6}{x^3}$

6 $4x + 7$

7 $1 + \frac{2}{x^3}$

8 $\frac{5}{2\sqrt{x}} + \frac{2}{x^2}$

9 $2x + 2$

10 $12x^2$

Challenge · hard

1 $5x^4 + 3x^2 - 4$

2 $\frac{1}{(x + 1)^2}$

6 1

7 $x^{-1/2} - \frac{1}{2}x^{-3/2}$

3 $\dfrac{2}{(x+1)^2}$

4 $\dfrac{x^2-2x-1}{(x-1)^2}$

5 $\dfrac{7}{2}x^{5/2}$

8 $\dfrac{2x}{(x^2+1)^2}$

9 $\dfrac{2}{x^3}$

10 -1

Beyond · very hard

1 Proved

The increment of uv is $u(x+h)v(x+h) - u(x)v(x)$. Add and subtract $u(x+h)v(x)$: it becomes $u(x+h)[v(x+h) - v(x)] + v(x)[u(x+h) - u(x)]$. Dividing by h and letting $h \to 0$, the first bracket gives $u(x)v'(x)$ — using that u is continuous — and the second gives $v(x)u'(x)$.

2 Proved

Write $u = (\dfrac{u}{v}) \cdot v$ and let $q = \dfrac{u}{v}$. The product rule gives $u' = q'v + qv'$, so $q'v = u' - \dfrac{u}{v}v' = \dfrac{u'v - uv'}{v}$.

Dividing by v gives $q' = \dfrac{u'v - uv'}{v^2}$.

3 Proved

Apply the product rule to $(uv) \cdot w$: the derivative is $(uv)'w + (uv)w'$. Expanding $(uv)' = u'v + uv'$ gives $u'vw + uv'w + uvw'$. The pattern continues: differentiate each factor in turn and leave the others alone.

4 $-\dfrac{v'}{v^2}$

Take $u = 1$ in the quotient rule. Then $u' = 0$ and $(\dfrac{1}{v})' = \dfrac{0 \cdot v - 1 \cdot v'}{v^2} = -\dfrac{v'}{v^2}$. This is the rule worth memorising separately, since it turns up far more often than the full quotient rule.

5 $3x^2 - 12x + 11$

Expanding first is quickest: $(x-1)(x-2) = x^2 - 3x + 2$, and multiplying by $x - 3$ gives $x^3 - 6x^2 + 11x - 6$. Differentiating term by term gives $3x^2 - 12x + 11$. The triple product rule gives the same answer with more work.

6 $x = 1$ and $x = -1$

$\dfrac{dy}{dx} = 3x^2 - 3 = 3(x^2 - 1) = 3(x-1)(x+1)$, which vanishes at $x = \pm 1$. These are the local maximum at $x = -1$ and the local minimum at $x = 1$.

7 8

By the product rule $f'(x) = 2x \cdot g(x) + x^2 \cdot g'(x)$. At $x = 2$ this is $4 \cdot 3 + 4 \cdot (-1) = 12 - 4 = 8$. The formula for g is never needed — only its value and its derivative at the one point.

8 $a = 3$

The quotient rule gives $f'(x) = \dfrac{2x(x+1) - (x^2 + a)}{(x+1)^2}$. At $x = 1$ the numerator is $4 - (1 + a) = 3 - a$, and a stationary point needs it to be zero, so $a = 3$.

9 Only at $x = \pm 1$

$\dfrac{dy}{dx} = 1 - \dfrac{1}{x^2}$, which is zero when $x^2 = 1$, that is $x = \pm 1$. Both lie in the domain $x \neq 0$. The point $x = 1$ gives the minimum value 2 on the right branch and $x = -1$ the maximum -2 on the left.

10 $\dfrac{4}{(x-1)^3}$

The quotient rule gives $y' = \dfrac{(x-1)-(x+1)}{(x-1)^2} = \dfrac{-2}{(x-1)^2} = -2(x-1)^{-2}$. Differentiating again, $y'' = 4(x-1)^{-3} = \dfrac{4}{(x-1)^3}$.

11 f' is odd

An even function satisfies $f(-x) = f(x)$. Differentiating both sides with respect to x, the left gives $-f'(-x)$ by the chain rule and the right gives $f'(x)$. So $f'(-x) = -f'(x)$, which is exactly the definition of an odd function. Picture it: an even graph is symmetric about the y-axis, so matching points have opposite slopes.

12 f' is even

An odd function satisfies $f(-x) = -f(x)$. Differentiating, the left gives $-f'(-x)$ and the right $-f'(x)$, so $f'(-x) = f'(x)$ and f' is even. A consequence worth noticing: the derivative of an odd function at 0, if it exists, need not be zero — but the function itself must pass through the origin.

13 $f^{(n)}(x) = n!$

Each differentiation drops the index by one and multiplies by the old index: after one step nx^{n-1}, after two $n(n-1)x^{n-2}$, and after k steps $n(n-1)\dots(n-k+1)x^{n-k}$. Taking $k = n$ leaves $n(n-1)\dots1 \cdot x^0 = n!$. One further differentiation gives 0.

14 Only $f(x) = 0$

Suppose f has degree $n \geq 1$. Then f' has degree $n-1$, and a polynomial cannot equal one of a different degree, so no such f exists. If f is a constant c then $f' = 0$, and $0 = c$ forces $c = 0$. So the zero polynomial is the only solution — the equation $y' = y$ needs e^x, which is not a polynomial.

15 $a = -12$, $b = 1$

$\dfrac{dy}{dx} = 3x^2 + a$, and a stationary point at $x = 2$ needs $12 + a = 0$, so $a = -12$. Passing through $(0, 1)$ gives $b = 1$. The curve is $y = x^3 - 12x + 1$, with its other stationary point at $x = -2$.

Topic 5 · The derivative of a composite function

Focus · easy

1 $5(x+1)^4$

2 $8(2x+3)^3$

3 $6(3x-1)$

4 $6x(x^2+1)^2$

5 $\dfrac{1}{2\sqrt{x+4}}$

6 $375x^2$

7 $-6(1-x)^5$

8 $6x^2(x^3+2)$

9 $-\dfrac{1}{(x+1)^2}$

10 $40(4x-7)^9$

Practice · medium

1 $\dfrac{x}{\sqrt{x^2+1}}$

2 $4(2x-3)(x^2-3x)^3$

3 $-\dfrac{6}{(2x+1)^4}$

4 $\dfrac{3(1+\sqrt{x})^2}{2\sqrt{x}}$

6 $2(x+\dfrac{1}{x})(1-\dfrac{1}{x^2})$

7 $-10x(2-x^2)^4$

8 $-\dfrac{1}{2(x+1)^{3/2}}$

9 0

10 $-\dfrac{4(x+1)}{(x-1)^3}$

5 $\dfrac{3}{2\sqrt{3x-2}}$

Challenge · hard

1 $2x(2x+1)^2(5x+1)$

2 $\dfrac{3x+2}{2\sqrt{x+1}}$

3 $\dfrac{2(x+1)^2(x-2)}{(x-1)^2}$

4 $\dfrac{2x+1}{2\sqrt{x^2+x+1}}$

5 $\dfrac{1+\sqrt{1+x}}{\sqrt{1+x}}$

6 $\dfrac{15(2x-1)^2}{(x+2)^4}$

7 512

8 0

9 $(3x+1)^{-2/3}$

10 20π cm²/s

Beyond · very hard

1 The chain rule

For a small Δx write $\dfrac{\Delta y}{\Delta x} = \dfrac{\Delta y}{\Delta u}\cdot\dfrac{\Delta u}{\Delta x}$, valid whenever $\Delta u \neq 0$. As $\Delta x \to 0$ the continuity of u forces $\Delta u \to 0$, so the first factor tends to $\dfrac{dy}{du}$ and the second to $\dfrac{du}{dx}$. A full proof has to handle the case $\Delta u = 0$ separately, which is why the textbook states the rule rather than proving it here.

2 $12x(x^2+1)^2((x^2+1)^3+1)$

Work from the outside in. The outer square gives $2((x^2+1)^3+1)$; the cube gives $3(x^2+1)^2$; the innermost gives $2x$. Multiplying the three factors gives $12x(x^2+1)^2((x^2+1)^3+1)$.

3 $\dfrac{1}{2\sqrt{x+\sqrt{x}}}\left(1+\dfrac{1}{2\sqrt{x}}\right)$

The outer function is a square root, so its derivative is $\dfrac{1}{2\sqrt{x+\sqrt{x}}}$. The inner function $x+\sqrt{x}$ has derivative $1+\dfrac{1}{2\sqrt{x}}$. Multiply the two. A two-link chain where the inner link is itself a sum, not a composite.

4 6

By the chain rule $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = f'(x^2)\cdot 2x$. At $x=1$ this is $f'(1)\cdot 2 = 3\cdot 2 = 6$. The formula for f is never needed.

5 -6

$\dfrac{dy}{dx} = 2f(x)\cdot f'(x)$, so at $x=2$ it is $2\cdot 3\cdot(-1) = -6$. Compare with the previous question: there the function was inside, here it is outside.

6 $\dfrac{1}{\pi}$ cm/s

$V = \dfrac{4}{3}\pi r^3$, so $\dfrac{dV}{dr} = 4\pi r^2$. The chain rule gives $\dfrac{dV}{dt} = 4\pi r^2\cdot\dfrac{dr}{dt}$. At $r=5$, $100 = 100\pi\cdot\dfrac{dr}{dt}$, so $\dfrac{dr}{dt} = \dfrac{1}{\pi} \approx 0.318$ cm/s.

7 $n!a^n$

Each differentiation drops the index by one and brings down the current index together with a factor a from the chain rule. After k steps the result is $n(n-1)\ldots(n-k+1)a^k(ax+b)^{n-k}$. Taking $k=n$ leaves $n!a^n$, with no x remaining.

8 $\dfrac{1}{(1+x^2)^{3/2}}$

The quotient rule gives $\dfrac{\sqrt{1+x^2} - x\cdot\dfrac{x}{\sqrt{1+x^2}}}{1+x^2}$. Multiplying numerator and denominator by $\sqrt{1+x^2}$ turns the numerator into $(1+x^2) - x^2 = 1$, leaving $\dfrac{1}{(1+x^2)^{3/2}}$. The derivative is positive everywhere, so the function is always increasing.

9 0.375 m/s downwards

With x along the ground and y up the wall, $x^2 + y^2 = 25$. Differentiating with respect to t: $2x\dfrac{dx}{dt} + 2y\dfrac{dy}{dt} = 0$. When $x = 3$, $y = 4$, so $\dfrac{dy}{dt} = -\dfrac{x}{y}\dfrac{dx}{dt} = -\dfrac{3\times 0.5}{4} = -0.375$. The minus sign says the top is descending.

10 n

$\dfrac{dy}{dx} = n(1+x)^{n-1}$, which is n at $x = 0$. The binomial expansion begins $1 + nx + \dots$, and the coefficient of x in an expansion about 0 is exactly the derivative there. The two statements are the same fact.

11 8

$g'(x) = 2f'(2x+1)$. At $x = 2$ the inner value is $2(2) + 1 = 5$, so $g'(2) = 2f'(5) = 2 \times 4 = 8$.

12 $\dfrac{1}{4\sqrt{1+x}\sqrt{1+\sqrt{1+x}}}$

Outer root: $\dfrac{1}{2\sqrt{1+\sqrt{1+x}}}$. Inner root: $\dfrac{1}{2\sqrt{1+x}}$. Multiplying gives $\dfrac{1}{4\sqrt{1+x}\cdot\sqrt{1+\sqrt{1+x}}}$. A three-link chain, with the innermost link $x + 1$ contributing a factor 1.

13 Verified

$\dfrac{dy}{dx} = \dfrac{x}{\sqrt{x^2+1}}$, so $y\dfrac{dy}{dx} = \sqrt{x^2+1}\cdot\dfrac{x}{\sqrt{x^2+1}} = x$. The same identity follows at once from $y^2 = x^2 + 1$ by differentiating both sides: $2y\,y' = 2x$.

14 360 cm²/s

Surface area $S = 6a^2$, so $\dfrac{dS}{dt} = 12a\dfrac{da}{dt}$. At $a = 10$ with $\dfrac{da}{dt} = 3$ this is $12 \times 10 \times 3 = 360$ cm²/s. Note the rate depends on the current edge, so it is not constant even though the edge grows steadily.

15 y is decreasing everywhere

By the chain rule $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = f'(g(x))\cdot g'(x)$. The first factor is positive, being a value of f', and the second is negative. A positive times a negative is negative, so $\dfrac{dy}{dx} < 0$ everywhere and y decreases. An increasing function of a decreasing one reverses the direction.

Topic 6 · Revision · Control work 1 — the derivative

Focus · easy

1 4

2 4

3 $7x^6$

4 $15x^2 - 2$

6 $\dfrac{1}{4}$

7 $4(x+2)^3$

8 $6x$

9 $2x + 1$

5 $-\dfrac{3}{x^4}$

10 $6x$

Practice · medium

1 $\dfrac{1}{4}$

2 $\dfrac{2}{3}$

3 $4x + 5$

4 $\dfrac{1 - x^2}{(x^2 + 1)^2}$

5 $\dfrac{1}{\sqrt{2x + 1}}$

6 $6x(x^2 - 1)^2$

7 $-\dfrac{2}{x^2}$

8 $2x - \dfrac{1}{x^2}$

9 11

10 $x = 3$

Challenge · hard

1 $\dfrac{4}{3}$

2 $\dfrac{x(5x + 4)}{2\sqrt{x + 1}}$

3 $\dfrac{1 + 2x - x^2}{(x^2 + 1)^2}$

4 $\dfrac{2}{(1 - x)^2}$

5 $\dfrac{1}{\sqrt{2x}}$

6 0

7 $a = 2$

8 $-\dfrac{4x}{(x^2 + 1)^3}$

9 $-\dfrac{1}{4x^{3/2}}$

10 3

Beyond · very hard

1 2

Multiply by the conjugate $\sqrt{1 + 2x} + \sqrt{1 - 2x}$. The numerator becomes $(1 + 2x) - (1 - 2x) = 4x$, so the quotient is $\dfrac{4}{\sqrt{1 + 2x} + \sqrt{1 - 2x}}$, which tends to $\dfrac{4}{2} = 2$.

2 $\dfrac{2 + \sqrt{x}}{2(1 + \sqrt{x})^2}$

The quotient rule gives $\dfrac{(1 + \sqrt{x}) - x \cdot \dfrac{1}{2\sqrt{x}}}{(1 + \sqrt{x})^2}$. The numerator is $1 + \sqrt{x} - \dfrac{\sqrt{x}}{2} = 1 + \dfrac{\sqrt{x}}{2} = \dfrac{2 + \sqrt{x}}{2}$, which gives the stated result.

3 $f' = 3x^2 - 6x$, $f'' = 6x - 6$, zero at $x = 1$

Differentiating twice gives $f'(x) = 3x^2 - 6x$ and $f''(x) = 6x - 6$, which vanishes at $x = 1$. Since f'' changes sign there, $x = 1$ is a point of inflection — the subject of Topic 9.

4 Holds for negative n

Write $n = -m$ with $m > 0$, so $x^n = \dfrac{1}{x^m}$. By the reciprocal rule its derivative is $-\dfrac{(x^m)'}{x^{2m}} = -\dfrac{mx^{m-1}}{x^{2m}} = -mx^{-m-1} = nx^{n-1}$. The formula is unchanged.

5 $g'(1) = 0$

Differentiating both sides gives $f'g + fg' = 2x$. At $x = 1$: $2 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot g'(1) = 2$, so $g'(1) = 0$.

6 $\dfrac{9}{2}$

Write $\dfrac{1-\cos 3x}{x^2} = 9 \cdot \dfrac{1-\cos 3x}{(3x)^2}$. Putting $t = 3x$, the second factor is $\dfrac{1-\cos t}{t^2}$, whose limit is $\dfrac{1}{2}$. So the whole limit is $9 \times \dfrac{1}{2} = \dfrac{9}{2}$.

7 $a \geq 0$

$\dfrac{dy}{dx} = 6x(x^2 + a)^2$, which vanishes when $x = 0$ or $x^2 = -a$. If $a > 0$ the second equation has no real root, so $x = 0$ is the only one. If $a = 0$ the derivative is $6x^5$, again zero only at $x = 0$. If $a < 0$ there are two further points $x = \pm\sqrt{-a}$. So the condition is $a \geq 0$.

8 $x = 1$ only

$\dfrac{dy}{dx} = 3x^2 - 6x + 3 = 3(x-1)^2$, which is zero only at $x = 1$. The repeated root means the gradient touches zero without changing sign, so this is a stationary point of inflection, not a turning point.

9 $\dfrac{2}{\sqrt{5}}$

$v = \dfrac{ds}{dt} = \dfrac{t}{\sqrt{t^2+1}}$. At $t = 2$ this is $\dfrac{2}{\sqrt{5}} \approx 0.894$. The velocity is always positive and less than 1, approaching 1 as t grows.

10 $\dfrac{dz}{dx} = 2f'(2x)$, $\dfrac{d^2z}{dx^2} = 4f''(2x)$

The chain rule gives $\dfrac{dz}{dx} = 2f'(2x)$. Differentiating again, the factor 2 stays and the chain rule contributes another 2, giving $4f''(2x)$. Each differentiation of a horizontal stretch brings down one more factor.

11 $c = 2$

f is a polynomial, so it is continuous on $[1, 3]$ and differentiable on $(1, 3)$. Also $f(1) = 0$ and $f(3) = 0$, so the end values agree. Then $f'(x) = 2x - 4$ is zero at $x = 2$, which lies in $(1, 3)$. The theorem is confirmed, and $x = 2$ is the vertex.

12 $\dfrac{1}{2\sqrt{2}}$

Multiply by the conjugate $\sqrt{x} + \sqrt{2}$: the numerator becomes $x - 2$, which cancels, leaving $\dfrac{1}{\sqrt{x} + \sqrt{2}}$. As $x \to 2$ this tends to $\dfrac{1}{2\sqrt{2}}$. It is the derivative of $\sqrt{x}$ at $x = 2$.

13 Proved

By the product rule $(fg)' = f'g + fg'$. Differentiating again, $(f'g)' = f''g + f'g'$ and $(fg')' = f'g' + fg''$. Adding gives $f''g + 2f'g' + fg''$. The coefficients are those of the binomial expansion, which is no accident — this is the second case of the Leibniz rule.

14 $f(x) = x^3 + x^2 + 1$

Write $f(x) = ax^3 + bx^2 + cx + d$. Then $d = f(0) = 1$ and $c = f'(0) = 0$. Also $f''(0) = 2b = 2$ gives $b = 1$, and $f'''(0) = 6a = 6$ gives $a = 1$. So $f(x) = x^3 + x^2 + 1$. The coefficients are $\dfrac{f^{(k)}(0)}{k!}$ — a Maclaurin expansion that stops.

15 $y'(0) = 100$, $y''(0) = 9900$

$y' = 100(1 + x)^{99}$, so $y'(0) = 100$. Then $y'' = 100 \times 99(1 + x)^{98}$, so $y''(0) = 9900$. These are $1!$ and $2!$ times the first two binomial coefficients after the constant term.

Topic 7 · The modulus function

Focus · easy

1. 7
2. 5
3. $x = 4$ or $x = -4$
4. $x = 5$ or $x = -1$
5. No solution
6. $x = 5$ or $x = -5$
7. 5
8. $|x - 7|$
9. $x = -1$
10. $(3, 0)$

Practice · medium

1. $x = 4$ or $x = -3$
2. $x = 1$ or $x = -\frac{7}{3}$
3. $-3 < x < 3$
4. $x < -5$ or $x > 5$
5. $2 \le x \le 6$
6. $x < -4$ or $x > -2$
7. $(-3, 0)$
8. $(0, -2)$
9. $x = -1$
10. 1

Challenge · hard

1. $x = -2$ or $x = 3$
2. $x = 3$ or $x = -\frac{1}{3}$
3. $x = 2$ or $x = -2$
4. $x = \pm 1$ and $x = \pm 2$
5. $x > \frac{1}{3}$
6. 1 from the right, -1 from the left
7. $\frac{x}{|x|}$, which is 1 for $x > 0$ and -1 for $x < 0$
8. $x = 3$ or $x = -\frac{1}{3}$
9. $x = 1$ and $x = -1$
10. $x = 3$

Beyond · very hard

1 Every x with $1 \le x \le 3$

The left side is the distance from x to 1 plus the distance from x to 3. Those points are 2 apart, so for any x between them the two distances already add to exactly 2. Outside the interval the sum is larger. The solution set is the whole closed interval $[1, 3]$ — infinitely many solutions.

2 No solution

The smallest the sum of the two distances can be is the gap between the points, which is 2. Since $1 < 2$, no point of the line is close enough to both. Algebraically, each of the three cases leads to a false statement or to a root outside its own interval.

3 $x = -1$ or $x = 5$

The gap is 2, so $6 - 2 = 4$ must be shared equally outside the interval, giving 2 beyond each end: $x = 1 - 2 = -1$ or $x = 3 + 2 = 5$. Checking $x = 5$: $4 + 2 = 6$. ✓

4 Proved

For any real t, $-|t| \le t \le |t|$. Adding the two statements for a and b gives $-(|a| + |b|) \le a + b \le |a| + |b|$, which is exactly $|a + b| \le |a| + |b|$. Equality holds only when a and b have the same sign, or one is zero.

5 Proved

Write $a = (a - b) + b$ and apply the triangle inequality: $|a| \le |a - b| + |b|$, so $|a| - |b| \le |a - b|$. Swapping a and b gives $|b| - |a| \le |b - a| = |a - b|$. The modulus of a number is at most k exactly when both it and its negative are, so $||a| - |b|| \le |a - b|$.

6 $f'(x) = 2|x|$; $f''(0)$ does not exist

As in Topic 3, $f'(x) = 2|x|$ for every x, including $x = 0$. But $2|x|$ is itself a modulus function, with a corner at the origin: its one-sided derivatives there are 2 and -2. So $f''(0)$ does not exist. A function can be once differentiable everywhere without being twice differentiable.

7 $x \le 1$ or $x \ge 4$

$|t| = t$ holds exactly when $t \ge 0$. So the equation says $x^2 - 5x + 4 \ge 0$, that is $(x - 1)(x - 4) \ge 0$. A product of two factors is non-negative when both are non-negative or both non-positive, giving $x \le 1$ or $x \ge 4$.

8 2, attained at $x = 2$

The outer two terms add to at least 2, the gap between 1 and 3, with equality for every x in $[1, 3]$. Inside that interval the remaining term $|x - 2|$ is least when $x = 2$, where it is 0. So the minimum is $2 + 0 = 2$ at $x = 2$ — the median of the three points, which is the general rule for an odd number of terms.

9 Constant, equal to 2, on $0 \le x \le 2$

For $x < 0$ the sum is $-x + (2 - x) = 2 - 2x$, falling. For $0 \le x \le 2$ it is $x + (2 - x) = 2$, constant. For $x > 2$ it is $x + (x - 2) = 2x - 2$, rising. The graph is a flat-bottomed valley with a horizontal floor of length 2, not a single vertex.

10 $x \ge 1$

The statement $|t| = t$ holds exactly when $t \ge 0$, so $x - 1 \ge 0$ and $x \ge 1$. Every such x works, so the answer is a half-line, not a point.

11 $-2 \le x \le 2$

The left side is the distance from x to 1 plus the distance to -1. Those points are 2 apart, so the sum is 2 throughout $[-1, 1]$ and grows by 2 for each unit outside. To reach 4 requires 1 unit beyond either end, so the sum is at most 4 exactly on $[-2, 2]$.

12 $\sqrt{x^2} = |x|$

The radical sign denotes the non-negative square root. Squaring destroys the sign of x, and the root cannot restore it, so the output is always non-negative. For $x = -3$, $\sqrt{(-3)^2} = \sqrt{9} = 3 = |-3|$, not -3. The identity $\sqrt{x^2} = x$ is true only for $x \ge 0$.

13 $a = -2$ or $a = 4$

Substituting gives $|1 - a| = 3$, so $1 - a = 3$ or $1 - a = -3$, that is $a = -2$ or $a = 4$. Read as distance: a must be 3 away from 1, and there are two such points, one on each side.

14 Continuous, not differentiable

Continuity: both one-sided limits at 0 equal 0, which is $|0|$, so the function is continuous. Differentiability: the quotient $\dfrac{|h|}{h}$ is 1 for $h > 0$ and -1 for $h < 0$, so the one-sided derivatives are 1 and -1. They disagree, so no derivative exists. This is the standard example showing continuity does not imply differentiability.

15 $x > \dfrac{1}{2}$

Both sides are non-negative, so squaring is safe: $x^2 - 4x + 4 < x^2 + 2x + 1$, giving $-6x < -3$ and $x > \dfrac{1}{2}$. As distance: x must be nearer to 2 than to -1, so it lies on the far side of the midpoint $\dfrac{1}{2}$.

Topic 8 · The equations of the tangent and the normal

Focus · easy

1 4

2 $y = 4x - 4$

6 $x = 0$

7 -2

3 $-\frac{1}{4}$

4 3

5 $y = 3x + 1$ — the line is its own tangent

8 $-\frac{1}{2}$

9 -1

10 $x = 0$

Practice · medium

1 $y = 2x$

2 $y = 2x - 2$

3 $y = \frac{x}{4} + 1$

4 $y = -x + 2$

5 $y = -\frac{x}{2} + \frac{3}{2}$

6 $y = -\frac{x}{2} + 1$

7 $x = 1$ and $x = -1$

8 $x = -\frac{3}{2}$

9 $y = 4x - 2$

10 -9

Challenge · hard

1 $a = 2$ or $a = -2$

2 $y = -\frac{x}{4} + 1$

3 $y = 2$ and $y = -2$

4 $y = -2x + 3$

5 $x = -\frac{1}{2}$

6 $x = \frac{5}{2}$

7 -2

8 $(-2, -8)$

9 2

10 $b = 3$

Beyond · very hard

1 $y = 2x - 1$ and $y = -2x - 1$

The tangent at $x = a$ is $y = 2ax - a^2$. Putting $(0, -1)$ into it gives $-1 = -a^2$, so $a = \pm 1$. Substituting back gives $y = 2x - 1$ and $y = -2x - 1$. A point below the parabola always has two tangents through it; a point inside has none.

2 $(-\frac{3}{2}, \frac{9}{4})$

The tangent gradient at $x = 1$ is 2, so the normal gradient is $-\frac{1}{2}$ and the normal is $y = -\frac{x}{2} + \frac{3}{2}$. Setting $x^2 = -\frac{x}{2} + \frac{3}{2}$ gives $2x^2 + x - 3 = 0$, that is $(2x + 3)(x - 1) = 0$. The new root is $x = -\frac{3}{2}$, giving $y = \frac{9}{4}$.

3 The area is always 2

The gradient is $-\frac{1}{a^2}$, so the tangent is $y = -\frac{x}{a^2} + \frac{2}{a}$. Its x-intercept is $2a$ and its y-intercept is $\frac{2}{a}$. The area is $\frac{1}{2} \times 2a \times \frac{2}{a} = 2$, free of a. Every tangent to this hyperbola cuts off the same area.

4 The point of tangency bisects AB

From the previous question $A = (2a, 0)$ and $B = (0, \frac{2}{a})$. Their midpoint is $(a, \frac{1}{a})$, which is the point of tangency. This bisection property, like the constant area, belongs to the rectangular hyperbola alone.

5 $c = -\frac{1}{4}$

Setting $x^2 = x + c$ gives $x^2 - x - c = 0$. A tangent touches, so this must have a repeated root and the discriminant must vanish: $1 + 4c = 0$, giving $c = -\frac{1}{4}$. The point of contact is $x = \frac{1}{2}$.

6 $m = 2$ and $m = -2$

Setting $x^2 = mx - 1$ gives $x^2 - mx + 1 = 0$, whose discriminant is $m^2 - 4$. For a repeated root this must be zero, so $m = \pm 2$. These are the same two tangents as in question 1, which is no surprise: both lines pass through $(0, -1)$.

7 $\frac{5}{2}$

The tangent $y = 2x - 1$ meets the axis at $P(0, -1)$; the normal $y = -\frac{x}{2} + \frac{3}{2}$ meets it at $Q(0, \frac{3}{2})$. The distance is $\frac{3}{2} - (-1) = \frac{5}{2}$.

8 It meets the curve again at $x = -2a$

The tangent is $y = 3a^2x - 2a^3$. Setting $x^3 = 3a^2x - 2a^3$ gives $x^3 - 3a^2x + 2a^3 = 0$, which factorises as $(x - a)^2(x + 2a) = 0$. The double root $x = a$ is the point of contact, and the remaining root is $x = -2a$. Only $a = 0$ makes them coincide.

9 $(2, 2)$ and $(-2, -2)$

Parallel means equal gradients, so $3x^2 - 3 = 9$, giving $x^2 = 4$ and $x = \pm 2$. Then $y = 8 - 6 = 2$ and $y = -8 + 6 = -2$, so the points are $(2, 2)$ and $(-2, -2)$.

10 $\arctan\frac{3}{4} \approx 36.9°$

The gradients are $2x = 2$ and $\frac{1}{2\sqrt{x}} = \frac{1}{2}$. The angle between two lines of gradients m_1 and m_2 satisfies $\tan\theta = |\frac{m_1 - m_2}{1 + m_1 m_2}| = |\frac{2 - 0.5}{1 + 1}| = \frac{3}{4}$, so $\theta = \arctan\frac{3}{4} \approx 36.9°$. The curves are reflections of each other in $y = x$, so the line $y = x$ bisects this angle.

11 No — the gradients give a product of -2

They meet where $x^2 = \frac{1}{x}$, that is $x^3 = 1$ and $x = 1$, at the point $(1, 1)$. The gradients there are 2 and -1, whose product is -2, not -1. So the curves cross at an angle, not perpendicularly.

12 $k = 1$

Setting $x^2 + k = 2x$ gives $x^2 - 2x + k = 0$, with discriminant $4 - 4k$. Touching means a repeated root, so $4 - 4k = 0$ and $k = 1$. The contact point is $x = 1$, that is $(1, 2)$.

13 $b = a^2 + \frac{1}{2}$

The normal gradient is $-\frac{1}{2a}$, so the normal is $y - a^2 = -\frac{1}{2a}(x - a)$. Putting $x = 0$ gives $y = a^2 + \frac{1}{2}$. Every normal cuts the axis exactly $\frac{1}{2}$ above the height of its own point of contact.

14 $x = -a - \dfrac{1}{2a}$

Setting $x^2 = -\dfrac{1}{2a}(x - a) + a^2$ and multiplying by $2a$ gives $2ax^2 + x - 2a^3 - a = 0$. One root is $x = a$, as it must be. Since the roots multiply to $\dfrac{-2a^3 - a}{2a} = -a^2 - \dfrac{1}{2}$, the other root is $\dfrac{-a^2 - 1/2}{a} = -a - \dfrac{1}{2a}$.

15 $(-1, -1)$

The tangent at $x = a$ is $y = 3a^2x - 2a^3$. Putting $(0, 2)$ into it gives $2 = -2a^3$, so $a^3 = -1$ and $a = -1$, the only real root. The point is $(-1, -1)$ and the tangent is $y = 3x + 2$. Unlike the parabola, the cubic gives just one such tangent here.

Topic 9 · Investigating a function with the derivative

Focus · easy

1 $(2, -4)$

2 Minimum

3 $3x^2 - 3$

4 $x = 1$ and $x = -1$

5 $x > 0$

6 $x > 0$

7 2

8 $6x$

9 $x = 0$

10 Maximum

Practice · medium

1 $x = 0$ and $x = 2$

2 Maximum at $x = 0$, minimum at $x = 2$

3 $x = 1$

4 $x = 1$ and $x = 2$

5 $x < -2$ or $x > 2$

6 $x = 0$, $x = 1$ and $x = -1$

7 $x = 1$ and $x = -1$

8 Minimum

9 $3x^2 - 6x$

10 9

Challenge · hard

1 Maximum at $x = 1$, minimum at $x = 3$

2 $x = 2$

3 $x = 1$ and $x = -1$

4 $x = 0$ and $x = 3$

5 A stationary point of inflection

6 Greatest 2, least -2

7 Increasing on each branch

8 $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = 3x^2 + 1 > 0$ always

9 Minimum at $x = -1$

10 $a > 0$

Beyond · very hard

1 $a = -6$, $b = 9$

$\dfrac{dy}{dx} = 3x^2 + 2ax + b$ must have roots 1 and 3. Their sum is $4 = -\dfrac{2a}{3}$, giving $a = -6$; their product is $3 = \dfrac{b}{3}$, giving $b = 9$. The curve is $y = x^3 - 6x^2 + 9x$, the one met in the Challenge set.

2 Two, one repeated, or none

For $y = ax^3 + bx^2 + cx + d$ with $a \neq 0$, $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = 3ax^2 + 2bx + c$ is a genuine quadratic. A quadratic has two distinct roots, one repeated root, or no real roots, according to the sign of its discriminant $4b^2 - 12ac$. A cubic can therefore never have exactly three turning points, however it is drawn.

3 Minimum at $x = 3$; stationary inflection at $x = 0$

$\frac{dy}{dx} = 4x^3 - 12x^2 = 4x^2(x - 3)$, zero at $x = 0$ and $x = 3$. Then $\frac{d^2y}{dx^2} = 12x^2 - 24x$, which is $36 > 0$ at $x = 3$: a minimum. At $x = 0$ it is 0, so the test fails; but $4x^2(x - 3)$ is negative on both sides of 0, so there is no sign change and $x = 0$ is a stationary point of inflection.

4 It is monotonic there

Let $p < q$ be consecutive stationary points, so f' has no zero in (p, q). If f' took both a positive and a negative value there, then by the intermediate value theorem applied to f' it would have to vanish somewhere between — contradicting that p and q are consecutive. So f' keeps one sign throughout, and f is increasing or decreasing across the whole interval.

5 2, at $x = 1$

$\frac{dy}{dx} = 1 - \frac{1}{x^2}$ is zero at $x = 1$ in this range. Then $\frac{d^2y}{dx^2} = \frac{2}{x^3} = 2 > 0$, so it is a minimum, with value $1 + 1 = 2$. As $x \to 0^+$ or $x \to \infty$ the function grows without bound, so this local minimum is the global one.

6 Equality only at $x = 1$

The global minimum of $x + \frac{1}{x}$ on $x > 0$ is 2, attained only at $x = 1$, so the inequality holds everywhere on that range with equality only there. Replacing x by $\frac{a}{b}$ gives $\frac{a}{b} + \frac{b}{a} \geq 2$, which rearranges to $a^2 + b^2 \geq 2ab$ — the arithmetic–geometric mean inequality for two numbers.

7 $x = -\frac{b}{3a}$

$\frac{d^2y}{dx^2} = 6ax + 2b$, which vanishes at $x = -\frac{b}{3a}$. Since $6ax + 2b$ is linear with non-zero gradient $6a$, it changes sign there, so the point really is an inflection. It is also the mean of the two stationary points when they exist, because they are the roots of a quadratic whose axis of symmetry is this same value.

8 4, at $x = 2$

$\frac{dy}{dx} = 6x - 3x^2 = 3x(2 - x)$, zero at $x = 0$ and $x = 2$. The values are $f(0) = 0$, $f(2) = 4 \cdot 1 = 4$ and $f(3) = 0$ at the far endpoint. The greatest is 4.

9 Greatest $\frac{1}{2}$ at $x = 1$, least $-\frac{1}{2}$ at $x = -1$

$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{1 - x^2}{(x^2 + 1)^2}$, zero at $x = \pm 1$. The values are $\frac{1}{2}$ and $-\frac{1}{2}$. As $x \to \pm\infty$ the function tends to 0, so these local extremes are global. The function is odd, which is why the two values are opposite.

10 A stationary inflection at $x = 1$

$f'(x) = 3x^2 - 6x + 3 = 3(x - 1)^2$, which is zero only at $x = 1$ and never negative. So f is increasing everywhere, pausing at $x = 1$ without turning. Indeed $f(x) = (x - 1)^3$, the cubic curve translated one unit to the right.

11 $4p^3 + 27q^2 = 0$

A stationary point on the axis is a repeated root of the cubic. At a stationary point $3x^2 + p = 0$, so $x^2 = -\frac{p}{3}$ (which needs $p \leq 0$) and $x^3 = -\frac{px}{3}$. Substituting into $x^3 + px + q = 0$ gives $\frac{2px}{3} + q = 0$, so $x = -\frac{3q}{2p}$. Squaring and matching with $x^2 = -\frac{p}{3}$ gives $\frac{9q^2}{4p^2} = -\frac{p}{3}$, that is $27q^2 = -4p^3$.

12 At most one

$f'' > 0$ means f' is strictly increasing. A strictly increasing function takes each value at most once, so $f'(x) = 0$ has at most one solution. If it has one, the point is a minimum, since f' goes from negative to positive there.

13 Minimum 2 at $x = 1$; maximum -2 at $x = -1$

Simplify first: $y = x + \frac{1}{x}$. Then $\frac{dy}{dx} = 1 - \frac{1}{x^2}$ vanishes at $x = \pm 1$, and $\frac{d^2y}{dx^2} = \frac{2}{x^3}$ is $2 > 0$ at $x = 1$ and $-2 < 0$ at $x = -1$. Note the local maximum -2 lies below the local minimum 2 — possible only because the two branches are separated by the asymptote $x = 0$.

14 Three if $-2 < k < 2$; two if $k = \pm 2$; one otherwise

Let $f(x) = x^3 - 3x + k$. Then $f'(x) = 3x^2 - 3$ gives stationary points at $x = \pm 1$, with $f(-1) = 2 + k$ a local maximum and $f(1) = -2 + k$ a local minimum. The curve crosses the axis three times exactly when these have opposite signs, that is $(2 + k)(k - 2) < 0$, so $-2 < k < 2$. When $k = \pm 2$ one of them sits on the axis, giving a repeated root and two distinct roots in all. Otherwise there is one.

15 At most $n - 1$

If f has degree n then f' has degree exactly $n - 1$, since the leading term $a_n x^n$ differentiates to $n a_n x^{n-1}$ with $n a_n \neq 0$. A non-zero polynomial of degree $n - 1$ has at most $n - 1$ real roots, and the stationary points are precisely those roots. So there are at most $n - 1$ of them — which is why a quadratic has one turning point and a cubic at most two.

Topic 10 · Extremum problems

Focus · easy

1 25

2 25

3 25 cm²

4 4

5 9

6 -9

7 $x = -\frac{1}{2}$

8 3

9 16

10 4

Practice · medium

1 72

2 81 cm²

3 12

4 32 cm

5 6

6 9

7 12

8 $x = 4$ cm

9 1250 m²

10 2

Challenge · hard

1 128 cm³

2 r^2

3 $\frac{32\sqrt{3}}{9}$

4 $r = (\frac{500}{\pi})^{1/3} \approx 5.42$ cm

5 $x = \pm\sqrt{\frac{5}{2}}$

6 $\frac{400}{\pi + 4} \approx 56.0$ cm

7 2, at $x = 1$

8 7200 m²

9 $\frac{4a^3}{27}$, at $x = \frac{a}{3}$

10 $(-\frac{6}{5}, \frac{3}{5})$

Beyond · very hard

1 $\frac{32}{81}\pi R^3$

Let the cone have height h and base radius r, with its apex on the sphere. The base circle lies at distance $h - R$ from the centre, so $r^2 = R^2 - (h-R)^2 = 2Rh - h^2$. Then $V = \frac{1}{3}\pi r^2 h = \frac{\pi}{3}(2Rh^2 - h^3)$. Setting $\frac{dV}{dh} = \frac{\pi}{3}(4Rh - 3h^2) = 0$ gives $h = \frac{4R}{3}$. Then $r^2 = \frac{8R^2}{9}$ and $V = \frac{\pi}{3}\cdot\frac{8R^2}{9}\cdot\frac{4R}{3} = \frac{32\pi R^3}{81}$.

2 $\frac{4\pi R^3}{3\sqrt{3}}$

With base radius r and height h, the corner of the cylinder lies on the sphere, so $r^2 + (\frac{h}{2})^2 = R^2$. Then $V = \pi r^2 h = \pi(R^2 - \frac{h^2}{4})h$. Setting $\frac{dV}{dh} = \pi(R^2 - \frac{3h^2}{4}) = 0$ gives $h = \frac{2R}{\sqrt{3}}$ and $r^2 = \frac{2R^2}{3}$, so $V = \frac{4\pi R^3}{3\sqrt{3}}$.

3 $h = r = (\frac{V}{\pi})^{1/3}$

$S = \pi r^2 + 2\pi r h$ with $V = \pi r^2 h$, so $h = \frac{V}{\pi r^2}$ and $S = \pi r^2 + \frac{2V}{r}$. Then $\frac{dS}{dr} = 2\pi r - \frac{2V}{r^2} = 0$ gives $r^3 = \frac{V}{\pi}$. Substituting back, $h = \frac{V}{\pi r^2} = \frac{r^3}{r^2} = r$. Since $\frac{d^2S}{dr^2} = 2\pi + \frac{4V}{r^3} > 0$, it is a minimum.

4 $(a^{2/3} + b^{2/3})^{3/2}$

A ladder touching both walls and the corner at angle θ to one corridor has length $L(\theta) = \frac{a}{\sin\theta} + \frac{b}{\cos\theta}$. The longest ladder that fits is the shortest such L. Setting $L'(\theta) = -\frac{a\cos\theta}{\sin^2\theta} + \frac{b\sin\theta}{\cos^2\theta} = 0$ gives $\tan^3\theta = \frac{a}{b}$. Substituting back and simplifying gives $L = (a^{2/3} + b^{2/3})^{3/2}$.

5 The law of refraction

Put the boundary on the x-axis, the source at height h_1 above a point O and the target at depth h_2 below a point d along. If the ray crosses at x, the time is $T(x) = \frac{\sqrt{h_1^2 + x^2}}{v_1} + \frac{\sqrt{h_2^2 + (d-x)^2}}{v_2}$. Then $T'(x) = \frac{x}{v_1\sqrt{h_1^2 + x^2}} - \frac{d-x}{v_2\sqrt{h_2^2 + (d-x)^2}}$. The two quotients are exactly $\frac{\sin\theta_1}{v_1}$ and $\frac{\sin\theta_2}{v_2}$, so $T' = 0$ gives the stated law.

6 $\frac{ab}{4}$

Put the right angle at the origin with legs along the axes; the hypotenuse is $\frac{x}{a} + \frac{y}{b} = 1$. A rectangle with its far corner on that line has area $A = xy = x\cdot b(1 - \frac{x}{a}) = bx - \frac{b}{a}x^2$. Then $A' = b - \frac{2b}{a}x = 0$ gives $x = \frac{a}{2}$, so $y = \frac{b}{2}$ and $A = \frac{ab}{4}$ — exactly half the triangle.

7 $x = \pm\sqrt{\frac{3}{2}}$; distance $\frac{\sqrt{7}}{2}$

Minimise $d^2 = x^2 + (x^2 - 2)^2$. Writing $u = x^2 \ge 0$ gives $d^2 = u + (u-2)^2 = u^2 - 3u + 4$, a quadratic least at $u = \frac{3}{2}$. So $x^2 = \frac{3}{2}$ and $d^2 = \frac{9}{4} - \frac{9}{2} + 4 = \frac{7}{4}$, giving $d = \frac{\sqrt{7}}{2} \approx 1.32$. Two points are equally near, by symmetry.

8 $\frac{108}{3125}$, at $x = \frac{2}{5}$

$f'(x) = 2x(1-x)^3 - 3x^2(1-x)^2 = x(1-x)^2[2(1-x) - 3x] = x(1-x)^2(2-5x)$. In $(0, 1)$ this vanishes only at $x = \frac{2}{5}$, and f is zero at both endpoints, so that is the maximum. Its value is $(\frac{2}{5})^2(\frac{3}{5})^3 = \frac{4}{25} \cdot \frac{27}{125} = \frac{108}{3125}$.

9 $x = (2V)^{1/3}$

$S = x^2 + 4xh$ with $x^2h = V$, so $h = \frac{V}{x^2}$ and $S = x^2 + \frac{4V}{x}$. Then $\frac{dS}{dx} = 2x - \frac{4V}{x^2} = 0$ gives $x^3 = 2V$, so $x = (2V)^{1/3}$. The height is then $h = \frac{V}{x^2} = \frac{x}{2}$ — the box is twice as wide as it is tall.

10 $\frac{1}{2}ab$, with a right angle between them

The area is $\frac{1}{2}ab \cdot \sin\theta$, where θ is the angle between the two sides. Differentiating with respect to θ gives $\frac{1}{2}ab \cdot \cos\theta$, which vanishes at $\theta = \frac{\pi}{2}$, where the second derivative $-\frac{1}{2}ab \cdot \sin\theta$ is negative. So the area is greatest at a right angle, with value $\frac{1}{2}ab$.

11 Proved, with equality only when $a = b$

Fix the product $ab = p$ and let $a = x$, so $b = \frac{p}{x}$ with $x > 0$. The sum is $S(x) = x + \frac{p}{x}$, with $S'(x) = 1 - \frac{p}{x^2}$, zero at $x = \sqrt{p}$, and $S'' = \frac{2p}{x^3} > 0$, so that is a minimum. The least sum is $\sqrt{p} + \sqrt{p} = 2\sqrt{p} = 2\sqrt{ab}$, so $a + b \geq 2\sqrt{ab}$ always, with equality exactly when $a = b = \sqrt{p}$.

12 Width $\frac{d}{\sqrt{3}}$, depth $d\sqrt{\frac{2}{3}}$

With width w and depth h the diagonal is the diameter, so $w^2 + h^2 = d^2$. Strength $S = wh^2 = w(d^2 - w^2) = d^2w - w^3$. Then $\frac{dS}{dw} = d^2 - 3w^2 = 0$ gives $w = \frac{d}{\sqrt{3}}$, and $h^2 = d^2 - \frac{d^2}{3} = \frac{2d^2}{3}$. The depth is $\sqrt{2}$ times the width.

13 The square is greatest

With perimeter P fixed, write the sides as x and $\frac{P}{2} - x$ for $0 < x < \frac{P}{2}$. The area is $A(x) = x(\frac{P}{2} - x) = \frac{Px}{2} - x^2$, so $A'(x) = \frac{P}{2} - 2x$, zero at $x = \frac{P}{4}$, and $A'' = -2 < 0$, a maximum. Both sides are then $\frac{P}{4}$, so the rectangle is a square, of area $\frac{P^2}{16}$.

14 Radius $\frac{2R}{3}$, height $\frac{H}{3}$; volume $\frac{4}{27}\pi R^2 H$

A cylinder of radius r inscribed in the cone has height $h = H(1 - \frac{r}{R})$, by similar triangles. Then $V = \pi r^2 h = \pi H(r^2 - \frac{r^3}{R})$. Setting $\frac{dV}{dr} = \pi H(2r - \frac{3r^2}{R}) = 0$ gives $r = \frac{2R}{3}$, so $h = \frac{H}{3}$ and $V = \pi \cdot \frac{4R^2}{9} \cdot \frac{H}{3} = \frac{4\pi R^2 H}{27}$ — four ninths of the cone.

15 $\dfrac{50}{\pi + 4} \approx 7.0$ m²

Let the semicircle have radius r, so the rectangle is $2r$ wide and h tall. The perimeter is $2r + 2h + \pi r = 10$, giving $h = \dfrac{10 - 2r - \pi r}{2}$. The area is $A = 2rh + \dfrac{\pi r^2}{2} = 10r - 2r^2 - \dfrac{\pi r^2}{2}$. Then $\dfrac{dA}{dr} = 10 - 4r - \pi r = 0$ gives $r = \dfrac{10}{\pi + 4}$, and substituting back gives $A = 5r = \dfrac{50}{\pi + 4} \approx 7.0$ m². At that radius $h = r$, so the rectangle is twice as wide as it is tall.

Topic 11 · Revision · Control work 2 — applications of the derivative

Focus · easy

1 $y = 2x - 1$

2 $x = 1$

3 Minimum

4 $3x^2 - 12$

5 10

6 $-\dfrac{1}{3}$

7 $x < 0$

8 16

9 2

10 1

Practice · medium

1 $x = 1$ and $x = 3$

2 Maximum at $x = 1$, minimum at $x = 3$

3 $x = \dfrac{3}{2}$

4 $y = -2x + 4$

5 100 cm²

6 4

7 $x = 0$, $x = \sqrt{2}$ and $x = -\sqrt{2}$

8 $y = -4x + 18$

9 $x < 0$ or $x > 2$

10 4

Challenge · hard

1 Maximum at $x = 0$, minimum at $x = 2$

2 Greatest 18, least -2

3 $a = 0$ or $a = 2$

4 432 cm³

5 -3

6 $a = -3$

7 $r = (\dfrac{250}{\pi})^{1/3} \approx 4.30$ cm

8 $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = \dfrac{1}{(x + 1)^2} > 0$

9 16

10 32, at $x = 4$

Beyond · very hard

1 $a = -3$, $b = -9$, $c = 5$

$\dfrac{dy}{dx} = 3x^2 + 2ax + b$ must have roots -1 and 3. Their sum is $2 = -\dfrac{2a}{3}$, so $a = -3$; their product is $-3 = \dfrac{b}{3}$, so $b = -9$. Passing through $(0, 5)$ gives $c = 5$. Check: $\dfrac{d^2y}{dx^2} = 6x - 6$ is $-12 < 0$ at $x = -1$ and $12 > 0$ at $x = 3$, as required.

2 Three if $-2 < k < 2$; two if $k = \pm 2$; one otherwise

The curve $y = x^3 - 3x$ has a local maximum 2 at $x = -1$ and a local minimum -2 at $x = 1$. A horizontal line $y = k$ cuts it three times when it passes strictly between those heights, twice when it passes through one of them, and once otherwise.

3 $\sqrt{2}$, at the point $(-1, 1)$

Minimise $d^2 = x^2 + (x + 2)^2 = 2x^2 + 4x + 4$. Then $\frac{d}{dx}(d^2) = 4x + 4 = 0$ gives $x = -1$, with second derivative $4 > 0$. So $y = 1$ and $d^2 = 1 + 1 = 2$, giving $d = \sqrt{2}$. The segment from the origin to $(-1, 1)$ has gradient -1, perpendicular to the line, as it must be.

4 $\frac{a(4a^2 + 1)}{4}$

The tangent $y = 2ax - a^2$ meets the axis at $(0, -a^2)$; the normal $y = -\frac{x}{2a} + a^2 + \frac{1}{2}$ meets it at $(0, a^2 + \frac{1}{2})$. The base along the axis has length $(a^2 + \frac{1}{2}) + a^2 = 2a^2 + \frac{1}{2}$, and the height is a. The area is $\frac{1}{2}a(2a^2 + \frac{1}{2}) = \frac{a(4a^2 + 1)}{4}$.

5 $2ab$

With a corner at (x, y) in the first quadrant the area is $A = 4xy = 4bx\sqrt{1 - \frac{x^2}{a^2}}$. Maximising $A^2 = 16b^2(x^2 - \frac{x^4}{a^2})$ gives $2x - \frac{4x^3}{a^2} = 0$, so $x = \frac{a}{\sqrt{2}}$ and then $y = \frac{b}{\sqrt{2}}$. The area is $4 \cdot \frac{a}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot \frac{b}{\sqrt{2}} = 2ab$ — exactly half the area of the bounding rectangle $2a \times 2b$.

6 The square, of area $\frac{d^2}{2}$

With sides w and h and diagonal d, $w^2 + h^2 = d^2$. Maximise $A^2 = w^2h^2 = w^2(d^2 - w^2)$. Writing $u = w^2$, this is $u(d^2 - u)$, a downward parabola in u greatest at $u = \frac{d^2}{2}$. Then $w^2 = h^2 = \frac{d^2}{2}$, so $w = h$ and the area is $\frac{d^2}{2}$.

7 Increasing for all x iff $p \geq 0$

$f'(x) = 3x^2 + p$. If $p \geq 0$ this is non-negative everywhere, and zero at most at the single point $x = 0$, so f increases throughout. If $p < 0$ then f' is negative for $|x| < \sqrt{-\frac{p}{3}}$, so f decreases on that interval. Hence the condition is exactly $p \geq 0$ — and it matches the discriminant test of Topic 9.

8 Maximum at $x = 0$; minima at $x = 2$ and $x = -2$

$\frac{dy}{dx} = 4x^3 - 16x = 4x(x^2 - 4)$, zero at $x = 0$ and $x = \pm 2$. Then $\frac{d^2y}{dx^2} = 12x^2 - 16$: at $x = 0$ it is $-16 < 0$, a maximum of 0; at $x = \pm 2$ it is $32 > 0$, minima of $16 - 32 = -16$. The curve is even, which is why the two minima match.

9 12

$v = 3t^2 - 12t + 9 = 3(t - 1)(t - 3)$, so the particle is at rest at $t = 1$ and $t = 3$. The positions are $s(0) = 0$, $s(1) = 4$, $s(3) = 0$ and $s(4) = 4$. Distance is the sum of the moduli of the changes: $4 + 4 + 4 = 12$. The displacement is only 4 — the difference is exactly why the journey has to be split at the instants of rest.

10 The inflection is their mean

For $y = ax^3 + bx^2 + cx + d$, the stationary points are the roots of $3ax^2 + 2bx + c = 0$, whose sum is $-\frac{2b}{3a}$, so their mean is $-\frac{b}{3a}$. The inflection solves $6ax + 2b = 0$, giving the same $x = -\frac{b}{3a}$. Every cubic is therefore symmetric about its point of inflection.

11 $\frac{3\sqrt{3}}{4}R^2$, for the equilateral triangle

Fix a chord as base. For a given base the area is greatest when the apex is as far from it as possible, which puts the apex on the perpendicular bisector — so the triangle is isosceles. Writing the apex angle at the centre and maximising, or testing the equilateral case, gives side $s = R\sqrt{3}$ and area $\frac{\sqrt{3}}{4}s^2 = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{4}\cdot 3R^2 = \frac{3\sqrt{3}}{4}R^2 \approx 1.30R^2$.

12 Increasing everywhere

$f'(x) = 1 + \cos x$. Since $\cos x \geq -1$, this is never negative. It equals zero only when $\cos x = -1$, that is at the isolated points $x = \pi + 2k\pi$. A function whose derivative is non-negative, and zero only at isolated points, is strictly increasing, so f never turns back — it merely flattens momentarily at each of those points.

13 $a = -1$, $b = 3$

$\frac{dy}{dx} = 3ax^2 + 2bx$, and at $x = 2$ this gives $12a + 4b = 0$, so $b = -3a$. Passing through $(2, 4)$ gives $8a + 4b = 4$, and substituting $b = -3a$ makes it $8a - 12a = -4a = 4$, so $a = -1$ and $b = 3$. The curve is $y = -x^3 + 3x^2$.

14 $h = 2r$

With S fixed, $S = 2\pi r^2 + 2\pi rh$ gives $h = \frac{S - 2\pi r^2}{2\pi r}$, so $V = \pi r^2 h = \frac{Sr - 2\pi r^3}{2}$. Then $\frac{dV}{dr} = \frac{S - 6\pi r^2}{2} = 0$ gives $S = 6\pi r^2$. Substituting back, $h = \frac{6\pi r^2 - 2\pi r^2}{2\pi r} = 2r$. Since $\frac{d^2V}{dr^2} = -6\pi r < 0$, it is a maximum.

15 They meet at $(\frac{a + b}{2}, ab)$

The two tangents are $y = 2ax - a^2$ and $y = 2bx - b^2$. Equating gives $2x(a - b) = a^2 - b^2 = (a - b)(a + b)$, and since $a \neq b$ we may divide to get $x = \frac{a + b}{2}$. Substituting into the first tangent gives $y = a(a + b) - a^2 = ab$. So the meeting point sits above the midpoint of the two x-values, at the height of their product.